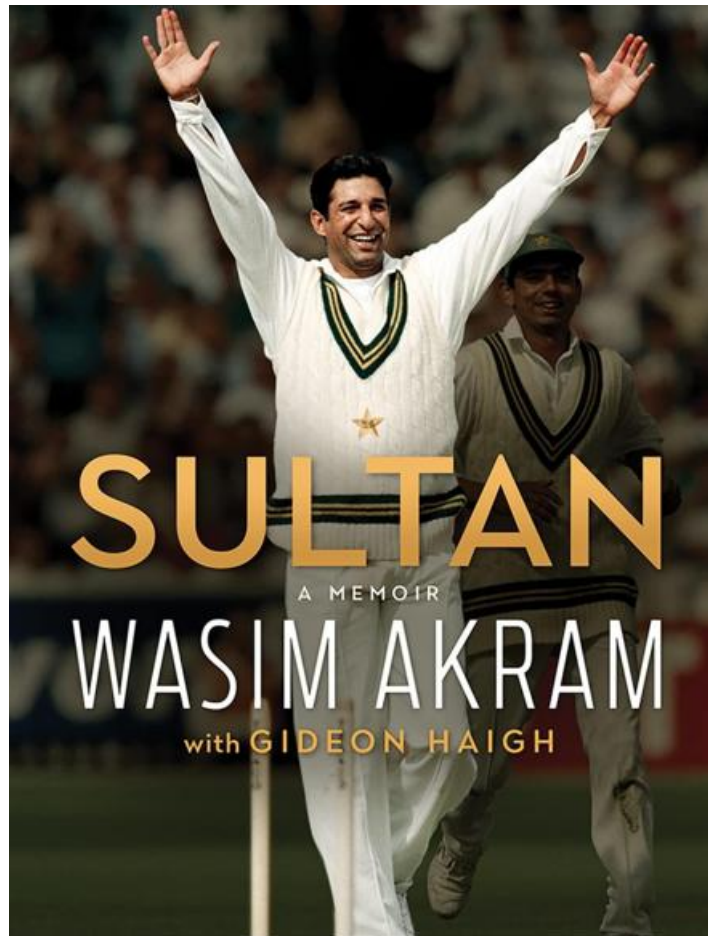


Sultan

Wasim Akram



Sultan

Unveiling the Untold Story of Cricket's Greatest Left-Arm Bowler.

Written by Bookey

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About the book

"Sultan" is the compelling official biography of Wasim Akram, renowned as the "sultan of swing" and heralded as one of cricket's all-time greatest fast bowlers. For two decades, Akram captivated audiences with his electrifying left-arm pace and fierce determination, becoming a pivotal figure in the sport. Now, for the first time, he shares the untold stories behind his extraordinary career, from his rise on the streets of Lahore to his triumph as man of the match in the historic 1992 World Cup. This gripping narrative delves into his fierce rivalries with legends like Viv Richards, Sachin Tendulkar, and Shane Warne, while also addressing the shadows of conspiracy surrounding ball tampering and match-fixing. Beyond the cricket field, "Sultan" explores the personal struggles Akram faced, including the devastating loss of his first wife and his battle with addiction. This biography offers an unmatched insight into the life of a cricketer who redefined the game, set against the complexities of a man's journey woven with triumph and sorrow.

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About the author

Wasim Akram, an iconic figure in the world of cricket, is widely regarded as one of the greatest fast bowlers of all time. Born on June 3, 1966, in Lahore, Pakistan, he made his international debut in 1984 and quickly rose to prominence with his extraordinary skill, agility, and the ability to swing the ball both ways. Akram's illustrious career spanned over two decades, during which he played pivotal roles in Pakistan's successful campaigns, including their 1992 Cricket World Cup victory. Beyond his on-field accomplishments, he has become a respected cricket commentator and a mentor to aspiring players. In his book "Sultan," Akram shares his journey, insights, and experiences, offering readers a deeper understanding of the game he loves and the challenges he faced along the way

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Chapter 1 : 1 The boy from the British Government

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Chapter 1 Summary : 1 The boy from the British Government



Section	Summary
Chapter Title	The Boy from the British Government
Early Life and Family Background	Wasim was influenced by his idol and coach, hailing from a traditional family with diverse emotional expressions between his parents.
Childhood Memories and Interests	He grew up in Model Town, Lahore, enjoying cinema and developing an early interest in sports, especially cricket.
Formative Cricket Experiences	Formed a street cricket team 'The British Government' and started excelling in cricket, gaining recognition.
Transition into Serious Cricket	A pivotal moment came when Khalid Mahmood offered him a place in a cricket club, leading him to serious practice and dedication to cricket.
Emerging Talent	Wasim participated in competitions, caught the attention of cricket figures, and received training opportunities.
First-Class Cricket Experience	With hard work and coaching, he made his first-class debut, overcoming setbacks and impressing selectors.
Introduction to International Cricket	Wasim reflects on his early performances, including underperforming on his debut against New Zealand, but later achieving recognition.
Legacy and Inspiration	His journey from aspiring cricketer to notable player is marked by inspiration from established players and familial support, overcoming challenges.

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Chapter 1: The Boy from the British Government

In this chapter, Wasim Akram reflects on his upbringing and early years that shaped his journey into cricket, marked by significant influences and events.

Early Life and Family Background

- Wasim was inspired by watching videos of his idol, Wasim Akram, who became his bowling coach at Kolkata Knight Riders.
- His father, Chaudhry Mohammad Akram, came from a traditional background, working as a court proofreader and running a spare parts business.
- His mother, Begum, married at a young age and was emotionally expressive, contrasting his father's quiet nature.

Childhood Memories and Interests

- Wasim recalls his early years in Model Town, Lahore, living in a comfortable suburban setting.
- He developed a love for cinema, particularly Bollywood, which enriched his childhood.

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- At school, he started to show interest in sports, particularly cricket, spurred by the legacy of Imran Khan, who attended his school.

Formative Cricket Experiences

- Wasim and his friends played street cricket, forming a team called 'The British Government,' which won numerous local games.
- He began to excel in cricket, gaining attention for his talent and embracing opportunities to play with better equipment and at suitable venues.

Transition into Serious Cricket

- A pivotal moment occurred when Khalid Mahmood, a former player, offered Wasim a chance to join a cricket club, marking the beginning of his serious cricket journey. - He practices diligently, focusing on developing his bowling skills without formal coaching.
- His family faced challenges, including his parents' separation, which impacted his emotional well-being but fueled his dedication to cricket.



Emerging Talent

- As he progressed in the sport, Wasim caught the attention of local cricketers and participated in various competitions.
- His performances led to invitations for training camps and further exposure to competitive cricket.

First-Class Cricket Experience

- With encouragement from teammates, he trained hard, receiving valuable coaching and finally making his first-class debut.
- Despite early setbacks, he showcased potential in subsequent matches, impressing selectors with his bowling.

Introduction to International Cricket

- Wasim reflects on his journey from local cricket to being invited for his first tour with the national team. - In his debut match against New Zealand, he underperformed but later rebounded, making significant contributions that led to his recognition.

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Legacy and Inspiration

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- His admiration for established players such as Imran Khangrew, leaving a lasting impact on him as he navigated the path from an aspiring cricketer to a notable player. - The chapter captures Wasim's humble beginnings, the support of his family, and his relentless passion for cricket that propelled him forward despite challenges.

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Example

Key Point: The importance of resilience and

determination in overcoming personal and professional challenges.

Example: Imagine yourself standing on a dimly lit street, a cricket bat in hand, surrounded by friends who share your dreams. You recall the struggles of your family and the emotional toll it took on you, yet your passion for the game burns brightly. Each practice session after school, rain or shine, represents an act of defiance against life's setbacks. As you bowl your heart out, envision the hypocrisy of critics fading with every successful delivery. Your efforts culminate in a local match where you showcase your skills, not just for applause but to honor the sacrifices made by those who believed in you. Through every setback and fleeting moment of self-doubt, the exhilarating rush of the game reminds you why you persist—it's not just a sport; it's your lifeline to a promising future.

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inspiration

Key Point: Perseverance in the Face of Adversity

Life inspiration: Wasim Akram's journey vividly demonstrates that the path to success is often strewn with challenges, but it is our reaction to these trials that ultimately defines us. Reflecting on his early life, you may find inspiration in the way he transformed personal setbacks, like his parents' separation, into a driving force for his passion for cricket. This chapter urges you to embrace your struggles, knowing that they can ignite an unwavering dedication toward your dreams. Just as Wasim honed his skills despite hardships, you too can harness your challenges as stepping stones, pushing through barriers with resilience and determination.

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Chapter 2 Summary : 2 The guru



Section	Summary
Early Impressions of Wasim Akram	Wasim Akram emerged as a formidable bowler by 1985, recognized for his diverse skills, rivaling only Malcolm Marshall in strategy against batsmen.
World Championship in Australia	During the 1985 World Championship in Australia, Akram learned about modern one-day cricket and received mentorship from Imran Khan, focusing on fitness and hard work.
Training Under Imran Khan	Imran Khan's rigorous training sessions provided Akram with essential bowling techniques, including the execution of yorkers.
Performing at the Melbourne Cricket Ground	Akram's debut at the Melbourne Cricket Ground saw him achieve exceptional bowling figures with 5 wickets, aided by Imran's strategic advice.
The Need for Experience	Initially struggling with bouncers, Akram adapted his approach after successfully dismissing a prominent batsman, learning vital lessons from Imran.
Building Routines and Skills	Akram valued Imran's unique coaching, focusing on reverse swing and endurance, enhancing his skills and ability to utilize bowling variations.
Sharjah: A New Territory	In Sharjah for a quadrilateral tournament, Akram faced local fame and team tensions but appreciated Imran's mentorship amidst the challenges.
The 1986 Sharjah Match	The historic match against India on April 18, 1986, showcased thrilling strategy from Javed Miandad, culminating in a memorable six and victory for Pakistan.
Culmination of Learning Experiences	Imran Khan took Akram's career seriously, providing critical match opportunities and advising him on adapting to conditions in Durham.

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The Importance of Independent Umpiring	Imran advocated for independent umpires to ensure fairness in cricket amidst fierce competition from the West Indies.
Conclusion: Rise of Wasim Akram	Akram's journey reflects growth and learning from legends, honing his skills, and establishing himself as a key player for the Pakistan cricket team.

Chapter 2: The Guru

Early Impressions of Wasim Akram

In 1985, Akram was instantly recognized as a formidable threat to batsmen due to his diverse bowling skills, which included a lethal yorker and an unpredictable bouncer. Among bowlers, only Malcolm Marshall was comparable in their ability to strategize against batsmen.

World Championship in Australia

During a two-week trip for the World Championship of Cricket in Australia, Akram experienced the modern style of one-day cricket, which was infused with excitement and innovation. With no structured coaching, Akram found a mentor in Imran Khan, who emphasized the importance of fitness and hard work.

Training Under Imran Khan

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Training sessions were rigorous and disciplined, filled with comprehensive fitness routines and bowling techniques. Akram learned valuable bowling strategies, including the execution of yorkers under Imran's guidance.

Performing at the Melbourne Cricket Ground

In his debut match at the Melbourne Cricket Ground, Imran's strategic advice helped Akram achieve exceptional bowling figures against Australia, taking 5 wickets.

The Need for Experience

Experiencing initial difficulties with bowling bouncers in one-day cricket, Akram learned to adapt his game, taking a crucial lesson from Imran when he successfully dismissed a well-known batsman using a bouncer.

Building Routines and Skills

Akram appreciated Imran's unique coaching techniques focused on reverse swing, training sessions that emphasized endurance, and a love for bowling. Through Imran's

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instruction, Akram improved his skills and learned to capitalize on bowling variations effectively.

Sharjah: A New Territory

Arriving in Sharjah for a quadrilateral tournament, Akram encountered both local fame and the tension between team members, particularly Imran and Javed Miandad. Nonetheless, he felt fortunate to be under Imran's mentorship.

The 1986 Sharjah Match

The match against India on April 18, 1986, became a historic encounter. Despite being in a dire position, Javed Miandad's strategic batting led to a thrilling victory for Pakistan, culminating in a memorable six that symbolized their cricketing rivalry.

Culmination of Learning Experiences

After successful tours and critical matches, Imran continued to take Akram's career seriously, providing opportunities in critical matches, including his encouragement to adapt to English conditions during a stint in Durham.

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The Importance of Independent Umpiring

As Pakistan faced intense competition from the West Indies, Imran sought to establish credibility by advocating for independent umpires, emphasizing the significance of fairness in cricket.

Conclusion: Rise of Wasim Akram

Akram's journey was marked by growth, learning from legends, honing his skills, and emerging as a key player for the Pakistan cricket team, amidst crucial developments in both his personal and professional life.

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Example

Key Point: The importance of mentorship in sports.

Example: Imagine yourself on the field, feeling overwhelmed by the competition. Just when you think you can't handle the pressure, a seasoned player steps in to guide you. Through their insightful tips and rigorous training routines, you transform your weaknesses into strengths, much like Wasim Akram did under Imran Khan's mentorship. Their guidance not only sharpens your skills but also instills a relentless work ethic within you, making you realize that the right mentor can be pivotal in mastering your craft and navigating challenges.

inspiration

Key Point: The value of mentorship and guidance

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Life inspiration: As you navigate through the challenges of life, consider how pivotal the role of a mentor can be, just as Wasim Akram experienced under Imran Khan. Embracing the wisdom and strategies offered by someone with more experience can illuminate your path and inspire you to push beyond your limits. Remember, every champion, like Akram, didn't rise through sheer talent alone, but thrived because of the guidance, discipline, and relentless work they embraced under the watchful eye of a mentor. This chapter encourages you to seek out mentors in your journey and to be open to their lessons; their insights could lead you to triumphs you never thought possible.

Chapter 3 Summary : 3 Imran, Viv and me

Section	Summary
Wasim Akram's Natural Gift	Wasim Akram, recognized for his talent by Viv Richards, developed his skills through guidance on wicket-taking and self-discipline.
The Political Climate in South Asia	During tensions between India and Pakistan, Imran Khan's cricket team played a key diplomatic role through the 'Cricket for Peace' initiative.
Imran's Leadership	In Mumbai, Akram admired Imran Khan's connections while he stayed focused on training through Imran's professional guidance.
Competitive Spirit and Performances	Akram excelled in Tests, achieving significant milestones like a five-wicket haul, amidst competitive high-scoring draws.

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Cultural Exchange	Festive interactions marked the series, with Pakistani players embracing local customs and celebrating victories over India.
Lancashire Contract Offer	Post-series, Akram received a prestigious and lucrative contract from Lancashire County Cricket Club.
Challenges in England	Upon arriving in England, Akram faced mixed reactions but adapted and experimented with his bowling despite challenges.
Memorable Matches and Rivalries	Akram's rivalry with Viv Richards intensified during competitive matches, testing his limits as a bowler.
The Highs and Lows of Tour	The tour was mixed, featuring historic wins and increased tensions with hostile crowds.
Anticipation for Future Triumphs	Akram looked forward to joining Lancashire and advancing his cricket career following an intense tour.

Chapter 3: Imran, Viv, and Me

Wasim Akram's Natural Gift

Wasim Akram, praised by fellow cricketer Viv Richards, emerged with immense natural talent and a keen passion for cricket. While Akram's action required little alteration, he learned from Richards the intricacies of wicket-taking and self-discipline to realize his potential.

The Political Climate in South Asia

During a time of unrest between India and Pakistan, Imran

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Khan's team was part of a diplomatic initiative called 'Cricket for Peace'. As Pakistan toured India for what would be their last series, Imran gained a quasi-ambassadorial role, reflecting Pakistan's identity.

Imran's Leadership

Upon arriving in Mumbai in February 1987, Akram admired Imran's status as he mingled with elite figures and engaged in significant promotional activities. Despite this, Imran maintained professional standards and ensured Akram stayed focused on rigorous training.

Competitive Spirit and Performances

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Akram faced competition from peers like Saleem Jaffar but

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Chapter 4 Summary : 4 Wasim for England

Summary of Chapter 4: Wasim for England

Overview of Wasim's Cricket Career

Wasim Akram is hailed as one of the greatest cricketers, known for his exceptional left-arm fast bowling skills, characterized by both speed and remarkable swing. Teaming up with Waqar Younis, they formed a formidable bowling partnership in cricket history. Wasim enjoyed his decade-long stint with Lancashire in England, where he became well-loved among teammates and made deep connections in the county.

Arrival in England and Team Dynamics

Upon arriving in England, Wasim was greeted by Lancaster coach Alan Ormrod and his new teammates, including players like Neil Fairbrother and David Hughes. His initial surprise at the team culture, which involved considerable

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socializing in bars, revealed the lighter side of a cricket team's bonding process.

Adapting to County Cricket

Wasim brought techniques from Pakistan, such as reversing the Dukes ball, which piqued his teammates' curiosity. Despite their skepticism, he worked hard on his training and even introduced new methods inspired by Imran Khan, highlighting the cultural differences between Pakistani and English cricket.

Cultural Experiences

Living in England introduced Wasim to a more communal cricketing environment where social norms required him to adapt, including his daily attire and dietary adjustments. His friendship with teammates deepened, leading to him sharing his cultural background through food and social gatherings.

Challenges and Triumphs

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Amidst injuries and adapting to new pressures, Wasim's cricketing skills flourished. He achieved a milestone with his first-class century and became a prolific wicket-taker. His competitive nature often clashed with team traditions, but eventually, he found ways to balance his heritage with a new lifestyle.

Personal Life and Relationships

Wasim experienced a romantic interest in Huma Mufti, a bright and engaging woman he met through mutual friends. Their brief romance propelled him to spend time away from cricket, demonstrating how love influenced his professional performance positively.

The Sporting Landscape

The chapter highlights Wasim's pivotal performances during domestic competitions and his crucial role in the national team amidst the political turmoil in Pakistan. His partnership with Waqar Younis as emerging fast bowlers was significant, setting the stage for future successes in international cricket.

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Conclusion: Balancing Identity and Professionalism

Wasim's journey reflects the challenges of transitioning from domestic cricket in Pakistan to the competitive arena in England, showcasing the complexities of balancing his cultural identity while striving for professional accolades. His experiences paved the way for further achievements on the cricket field, revealing the intertwined nature of personal and professional growth.

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Example

Key Point: Balancing cultural identity with

professional obligations is crucial for personal growth and success.

Example: Imagine stepping onto a cricket field in England, where the winds whisper stories of camaraderie, and team members invite you to join them for a pint after a match. You feel the warmth in their laughter, the unity forged over shared experiences, yet you find yourself grappling with whether to embrace their social rituals or remain true to your roots. As you sip that drink, you start blending your Pakistani heritage into conversations, sharing spiced dishes at gatherings, establishing connections through the universal love of cricket. This delicate dance of honoring your traditions while immersing yourself in a new culture becomes pivotal, shaping not just your career as a cricketer but enriching your journey as an individual in a foreign land.

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Chapter 5 Summary : 5 An all-rounder at last

CHAPTER 5: AN ALL-ROUNDER AT LAST

Overview of Wasim Akram's Admiration

The author expresses high regard for Wasim Akram, considering him one of the greatest left-arm quick bowlers in cricket history.

Anticipation for Upcoming Tests in Australia

Excitement builds for three upcoming Tests in Australia, with hopes riding on improving batting skills to complement bowling, breaking away from Pakistan's traditional division of labor for bowlers.

Influence of County Cricket

County cricket reshaped the author's attitude towards all-round capabilities, emphasizing that bowlers should also be

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competent batters. This change allowed for experimentation in techniques and aided the author in refining both bowling and batting skills through observation and practice.

Learning from Peers

The author discusses the influence of cricketers like Franklyn Stephenson, who inspired him to explore pace variations, and reflects on how he learned from various batting styles in county cricket.

Test Matches in Australia

During a Test match in Melbourne, the author showcases his bowling skills, achieving impressive figures. However, the batting performance of his team falls short despite individual efforts, which leads to a narrow defeat.

Performance Under Pressure

Following up the Melbourne Test, the author contributes valuable runs in the second Test, lifting team morale despite ongoing injury issues. He describes his experience of batting

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alongside Imran Khan, gaining confidence and composure at the crease.

Professional Growth and Injuries

The author shares his recovery journey from injury, marked by successful surgeries and a quick return to the game. His performances in various matches demonstrate a blend of resilience and skill.

Competition and Rivalry

Interactions with Waqar Younis, another Pakistani bowler, highlight the competitive spirit and camaraderie among cricketers in the county circuit, fueling their growth and success.

County Cricket Finals and Achievements

The author narrates the excitement surrounding county cricket finals, their collective aim for trophies, and recognizes the hard work that went into winning events like the Benson & Hedges Cup.

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Reflections on Gentle, Yet Draining Life as a Cricketer

Despite the enjoyable moments in cricket, the author acknowledges moments of frustration, particularly due to injuries and conflicts with umpires, indicating the pressures of being a prominent overseas player.

Conclusion: Learning from Experience

The chapter concludes with a reflection on the lessons learned throughout these experiences, emphasizing cricket as a rigorous but rewarding teacher in life and sport.

inspiration

Key Point: The importance of being an all-rounder

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both in cricket and life.

Life inspiration:As you dive into the story of Wasim Akram's journey, you can't help but feel inspired by the concept of being an all-rounder. Just as Akram learned to adapt by refining both his bowling and batting skills, you too can embrace versatility in your own life.

Imagine the opportunities that blossom when you step beyond the confines of a single role—be it in your career, hobbies, or relationships. By cultivating a range of skills and being open to learning from others, you'll not only enhance your capabilities but also build resilience to overcome challenges. Like Akram's experience on the cricket field, where his all-round contributions lifted team morale and paved the way for success, you can create a fulfilling and enriched life by embracing a multifaceted approach, pushing boundaries, and growing from every experience.

Chapter 6 Summary : 6 1992 and all that

CHAPTER 6 SUMMARY

Facing the Best Bowler

The chapter opens with reflections on Wasim Akram, a left-arm fast bowler known for his exceptional speed, swing, and skill, ultimately regarded as the hardest bowler faced by many cricketers. His dual nature as both an intimidating cricketer and a gentleman off the field is highlighted.

Preparation for the 1992 World Cup

The chapter narrates the bizarre journey of the Pakistan cricket team leading up to the 1992 World Cup, including an unusual training camp in Lahore, challenges with low-performing pitches against Sri Lanka, and injuries to key players like Waqar. They encountered poor form in warm-up matches, raising doubts about their capabilities.

Youthful Energy and Team Dynamics

Despite the setbacks, the team was filled with young, talented players like Aamir Sohail and Inzamam-ul-Haq, which created a sense of hope. The chapter emphasizes the leadership of Imran Khan, who was determined to build a cancer hospital in Lahore, instilling a strong sense of mission and responsibility in his players.

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Struggles in the Group Stage

The matches in the World Cup showcased the team's early struggles, including losses and insufficient performances against teams like the West Indies and England. However, the team remained spirited, especially with the cultural backdrop of Ramadan providing motivation.

Clutch Victory and Semi-Final Tension

The team eventually rallied, producing critical victories, including a notable performance against New Zealand. The excitement of reaching the semi-finals was palpable, yet the team continued to face challenges, such as injuries and pressure-filled situations. **Audio**

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Chapter 7 Summary : 7 A reluctant captain

A RELUCTANT CAPTAIN

Overview of Relationships in the Team

Wasim Akram discusses the complex dynamics within the Pakistan cricket team, particularly between Javed Miandad and Imran Khan. Javed held the captaincy and strong control of the team, while Akram had faced misunderstanding regarding his injuries.

Tour Sponsorship and Performance

During a successful summer tour in England, the team, sponsored by Tetley, earned bonuses for winning matches. Akram highlights the advantage of reverse swing and a strong team lineup, emphasizing their consistency and determination.

Challenges with Leadership

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Akram narrates his experiences under Javed's captaincy, including conflicts in bowling strategy and performance expectations. The team succeeded in crucial matches but faced ups and downs due to internal tensions and Javed's abrasive nature.

Controversy and Umpiring Issues

The relationship between the teams was complicated by media controversies and umpiring decisions, particularly regarding accusations of ball tampering and suspicions about reverse swing. Akram discusses public perception and the aftermath of these incidents.

Emergence of New Leadership

After the tour, Akram unexpectedly became captain of Pakistan after Javed's leadership faced criticism, leading to a shift in management decisions. Akram felt unequipped for the role, lacking experience and support from senior players.

Struggles as Captain

His initial journey as captain was filled with challenges, including clashes with senior players like Waqar Younis and

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ongoing issues of discipline and team unity. Akram wrote about feelings of isolation and pressure.

Touring and Incidents in the Caribbean

A significant incident occurred in the Caribbean when Akram and teammates faced legal troubles over alleged drug possession. Despite being exonerated, the event led to a media frenzy and strained relationships within the team.

Reflections on Captaincy

Throughout his captaincy tenure, Akram acknowledges struggles with maintaining authority and support. He also reflects on the challenges of leading a team divided by personal ambitions and rivalries.

Conclusion of the Chapter

Akram describes the culmination of his experiences, including a tumultuous tour of New Zealand, where he

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performed well individually, but the team atmosphere remained tense. The chapter ends with hints of future troubles within Pakistan cricket as new management structures emerge, suggesting a turbulent period ahead.

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Chapter 8 Summary : 8 Dirty money

CHAPTER 8: DIRTY MONEY

Bowling Mastery

Wasim Akram's unique bowling style, characterized by stealth, skill, and exceptional movement, made him a formidable opponent on the pitch. His ability to switch between bowling styles kept batsmen on edge, earning him a place among the greatest fast bowlers.

Corruption in Pakistani Cricket

Akram reflects on the early signs of corruption in Pakistani cricket, recalling an instance before the Austral-Asia Cup final in 1990 where Imran Khan decided to bet on their victory to motivate the team. He acknowledges the susceptibility of the cricketing system to malpractice and the complex dynamics of trust within the elite circle of players.

Team Disarray

As the leadership of the team shifted after the retirements of key players, Akram felt increasingly alienated from his teammates. The atmosphere became tense with rumors of match-fixing, leading to suspicion and disengagement amongst players, particularly during a tour to New Zealand.

Rumors and Allegations

Significant events unfolded, including allegations of match-fixing which created further discord within the team. Akram recounts receiving ominous phone calls predicting losses and witnessing accusations of bribery against teammates, which led to a culture of mistrust.

Fractured Relationships

The disconnection between players grew, culminating in public allegations against Saleem Malik of offering money to Australian players to underperform. Akram struggled with feelings of betrayal and a lack of camaraderie in the team, leading to personal frustration.

Turning Points and Leadership Challenges

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After a series of defeats and internal conflicts, changes in leadership within the PCB resulted in further instability. Akram was compelled to step up amidst these chaotic circumstances, ultimately leading the team through rough patches, despite lingering concerns about the integrity of his teammates and the sport's governance.

Conclusion

Amidst the challenges, Akram found solace in personal victories and a return to form during his time playing club cricket in England, where he rediscovered joy in the game, contrasting sharply with the tumultuous environment of Pakistani cricket during that period.

Chapter 9 Summary : 9 Taking on the world

Chapter 9: Taking on the World

Wasim's Leadership Journey

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Wasim Akram reflects on his return to captaincy after a rocky start, acknowledging previous failures and learning from them. Maturity and advice from his wife, Huma, helped him accept the position with a new mindset, aiming to lead authentically rather than through false authority.

Challenges in Australia

The chapter outlines the struggles of the Pakistani team during their tour in Australia, highlighting a disastrous First Test at the Gabba. Despite catching issues, Wasim maintained optimism about the team's talent, while also enjoying his interactions with Australian counterpart Mark Taylor.

First Test Highlights

At Hobart, Wasim demonstrates his leadership by opening the bowling and achieving early success. His performances improve across the series, culminating in a hard-fought victory in Sydney where Pakistan overcame Australia after previously losing in Brisbane.

Preparations for the World Cup

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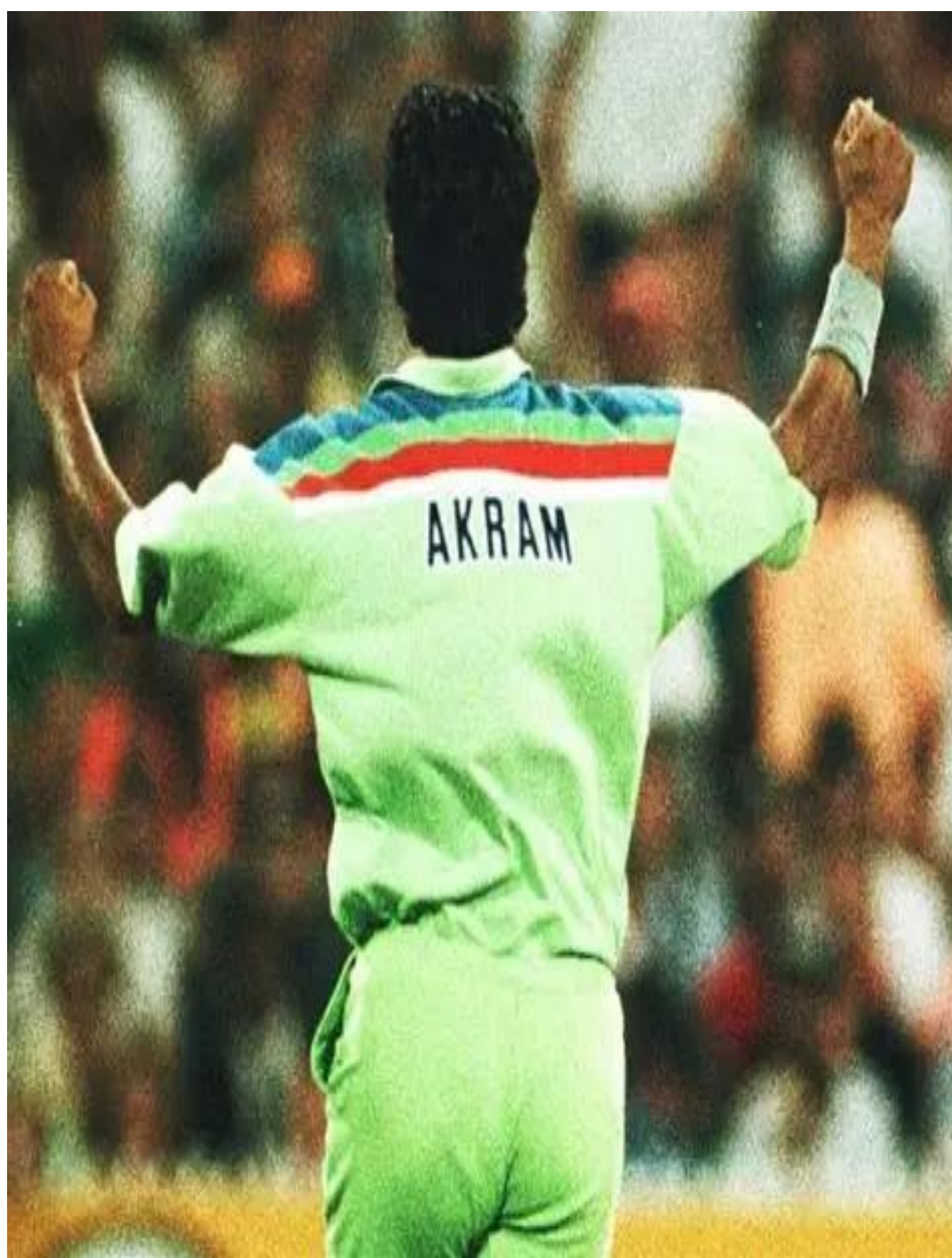
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Wasim discusses the shift in team dynamics as they prepared for the World Cup, co-hosted in 1996 with India and Sri Lanka. The squad's mix of seasoned players and emerging talents, including the explosive Shahid Afridi, fuels hopes for success.

World Cup Aspirations and Obstacles

The chapter describes the initial optimism ahead of the World Cup, including the team's strong roster. However, internal struggles, particularly pressure from selectors regarding older players versus promising newcomers, lead to a rocky start.

Audio



Chapter 10 Summary : 10 Under investigation

CHAPTER 10: UNDER INVESTIGATION

Overview

Wasim Akram, a legendary Pakistani cricketer, faced allegations of match-fixing during a turbulent era for the Pakistani cricket team. Despite personal challenges, including a diabetes diagnosis, Akram navigated through suspicions and controversy that impacted his career and those around him.

Achievements and Personal Struggles

Akram's prowess as a fast bowler and lower-order batsman intimidated opponents, even as he battled type 1 diabetes. His personal life was marked by anxiety, largely owing to his father's kidnapping, which intensified his distrust of friends.

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His close friend, Zafar Iqbal (Jojo), evolved into a bookmaker, leading Akram to reflect on the value of childhood friendships.

Allegations and Internal Conflicts

Following the 1996 World Cup fiasco, whispers of fixing began to engulf Pakistani cricket, exacerbated by allegations from Indian players and escalating accusations against their own squad. Notably, Aamir Sohail claimed potential fixes surrounding past matches, stirring chaos within the team. Akram felt targeted, blamed for failures, and accused of conspiracy even when innocent.

Injuries and Transition

Akram's shoulder injury significantly affected his performance, leading to a complicated recovery that intersected with both his personal and professional life. He eventually underwent surgery and became a father, signaling a new chapter, albeit amidst ongoing scrutiny of his cricketing integrity.

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Shift in Leadership and Selection

Amid intense speculation, leadership in the Pakistani team shifted, with Akram being removed from selection based on fading credibility rather than performance. The PCB began a fact-finding investigation, which amplified tension, resulting in a temporary committee led by Justice Qayyum.

Investigations and Legal Proceedings

The inquiry became a battleground of conflicting testimonies and suspicions, with significant emphasis on hearsay rather than substantial evidence. Akram faced isolation as former teammates distanced themselves from him, and he encountered both paranoia and depression amid the allegations.

Impact of Allegations

As the investigations progressed, Akram felt the emotional toll deeply. Despite strong performances, he faced relentless questioning, which contributed to a growing rift within the team, undermining morale and cohesion. The inquiry

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concluded with dissatisfaction, yet exoneration from many, even as he remained skeptical of team dynamics.

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Conclusion

The chapter encapsulates a challenging period in Wasim Akram's life, marked by athletic achievements overshadowed by controversy, personal trials, and a profound sense of isolation amidst the storm of accusations that rocked Pakistani cricket. Through adversity, he learned important lessons about trust, friendship, and resilience that would shape his future.

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Chapter 11 Summary : 11 Mission to India

CHAPTER 11: MISSION TO INDIA

Overview

In Chapter 11 of "Sultan," Wasim Akram reflects on his cricketing career and the significance of his visit to India as captain of the Pakistani team in 1999. The chapter highlights the interplay of cricket, politics, and personal experiences during this historic tour.

Wasim Akram's Influence

Akram is celebrated as an inspiration for fast bowlers, especially in the Subcontinent, marking the impact of television on aspiring cricketers. His competitive spirit and the joy he brought to the game are acknowledged through the words of rival cricketer Rahul Dravid.

Challenges of Playing in India

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The chapter discusses the complexities of playing cricket in India, influenced by political tensions between Pakistan and India. Akram reflects on the improbability of matches between the two nations and expresses hope for improved relations.

Team Selection and Preparations

Following his appointment as captain, Akram focuses on assembling a competitive squad, with notable mentions of young talents like Shoaib Akhtar and Shahid Afridi. The chapter illustrates the buildup to the tour amid rising nationalist sentiments and the extraordinary anticipation surrounding the matches.

Facing Adversity

Amidst security threats and protests, the tour goes ahead, offering a glimpse into the challenges faced by the teams and management. Akram assures his teammates to focus on the positives, understanding the immense pressure on the hosts.

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Match Highlights

The excitement of the tour culminates during intense Test matches. Notable performances, including Afridi's exceptional innings and Tendulkar's brilliant knock, underline the cricketing rivalry. Akram recounts key moments, including Tendulkar's dismissal and the thrilling conclusion of the matches.

Cultural Impact and Security Concerns

The chapter emphasizes cricket's transcendent role in fostering goodwill between nations, despite an undercurrent of tension. The passionate reception from Indian fans and Akram's thoughtful engagement with the cultural dynamics are prominently featured.

Conclusion

The chapter concludes on a reflective note, celebrating the unique cricketing relationship between Pakistan and India, emphasizing that despite political tensions, cricket continues

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to unite fans across borders. Akram's experiences underscore the profound impact of the sport on personal and national identities.

Chapter 12 Summary : 12 A cup forfeited

Chapter 12: A Cup Forfeited

Rivalry in Cricket

Cricket's essence lies in the competition between batter and bowler, with Wasim Akram serving as an extraordinary rival for every batter who faced him. Akram's natural run-up and ability to make the ball 'talk' elevated the game for all involved. Sachin Tendulkar reminisces about the unforgettable encounters with Akram, highlighting the friendship forged through their rivalry.

Team's Transformation Before the World Cup

As the 1999 World Cup approached, Pakistan's cricket team rejuvenated itself, showcasing strong performances including victories in the Pepsi Cup and Coca-Cola Cup. However,

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concerns about match-fixing loomed, exacerbated by rumors and unsettling discussions among players.

Match-Fixing Allegations

A pivotal match in the Coca-Cola Cup against England ignited allegations of fixing when Javed Miandad claimed he had inside information regarding certain players' involvement in a scam. Despite the growing tension, Pakistan lost the match due to internal pressures and inability to forge partnerships.

Coaching Decisions and the World Cup Preparation

Following administrative changes, Akram gained greater control over team selections for the World Cup. The strategy involved capitalizing on bowling strengths and adapting to English pitches. The team boasted a strong line-up, preparing for a bowler-dominant tournament.

World Cup Journey: Success and Failures

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Pakistan began the World Cup strongly but faced challenges,**Install Bookey App to Unlock Full Text** **and** including a sudden defeat against Bangladesh, followed by a**Audio** disheartening loss to India during a politically tense



Chapter 13 Summary : 13 General disarray

CHAPTER 13: GENERAL DISARRAY

Overview of Wasim Akram's Skills

Wasim Akram was recognized as one of cricket's greatest fast bowlers. Notable for his speed, left-arm angle, and ability to swing the ball, he was a formidable opponent. Despite his prowess on the field, he also excelled as an all-rounder.

Changes in PCB Leadership

Following Musharraf's chairmanship of the PCB, significant personnel changes occurred, including the hiring of Lt. Gen. Tauqir Zia as chairman. Tauqir exhibited preference for his allies and had a fondness for Shoaib Akhtar, leading to divisions within the team. **Shoaib's Bowling Ban**

An unexpected bowling ban was imposed on Shoaib by the ICC, to which Tauqir quickly responded by negotiating a compromise that limited his bowling style during a crucial series. The team performed well despite internal conflicts, reaching the finals.

Tensions Among Team Members

Tauqir's management style stirred tension, particularly with captains and senior players. Conflicts emerged between Tauqir and the coaching staff, notably during matches when strategies were undermined by the leadership changes.

Decline of Akram's Captaincy

Akram sensed his position weakening as rival players sought to undermine his authority. The subsequent appointment of Saeed Anwar as captain led to further defeats in international matches.

Emergence of New Players

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Despite Akram's struggles, fresh talent like Younis Khan made remarkable debuts, indicating a potential shift within the team. However, the shadow of match-fixing allegations loomed over the team, particularly involving Akram and others.

Match-Fixing Allegations and Qayyum Inquiry

The inquiry into match-fixing adversely affected Akram's standing, leading to penalties against several players despite the suspicion being unfounded. A significant part of the report suggested Akram's involvement, which he vehemently denied.

Recognition of Injustice

Akram reflected on the injustice of the report, feeling it tarnished his reputation without adequate evidence. He expressed disappointment over the mishandling of allegations, noting that the accusations stemmed primarily from internal rivalries rather than facts.

Challenges and Resilience

In the face of adversity, Akram sought to prove his worth on

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the field, showcasing impressive performances even as injuries and managerial disputes hindered his career. The chapter outlines significant personal and professional struggles against a backdrop of cricket politics.

Overall, this chapter encapsulates the turbulence in Akram's life, the shifting dynamics within the Pakistan cricket team, and the trials he faced amid a culture rife with jealousy and suspicion.

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Example

Key Point: The importance of resilience in overcoming challenges

Example: In the chaos of team conflicts and external pressures, you find yourself embodying resilience, pushing through setbacks. Each match feels like a new challenge, but your determination to excel drives you forward amidst whispers of discontent from teammates and management. You focus on your skills, honing your craft to prove doubters wrong, much like Akram did during his tumultuous career, showcasing that inner strength can emerge even when faced with overwhelming odds.

Chapter 14 Summary : 14 Battling my demons

Chapter 14: Battling My Demons

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Mastery and Humility

Wasim Akram reflects on his cricketing journey, comparing his craft to that of renowned golfer Ben Hogan. Despite his greatness, Wasim is portrayed as humble and generous, embodying the fallibilities of human experience.

Retirement and Transition

After the World Cup, Wasim experiences a forced exit from international cricket, compounded by significant changes in team management. His last appearances in international cricket were anticlimactic, prompting him to seek continued play at Hampshire to make a case for international selection.

Personal Struggles

Living away from his family in Hampshire, Wasim grapples with feelings of loneliness. Despite his initial enjoyment of T20 cricket, homesickness pushes him to return to Pakistan where he receives recognition from sponsors at a farewell event.

Career Shift to Commentary

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With a lack of financial security post-retirement, Wasim is offered a commentator role by ESPN Star, marking a challenging transition from player to commentator. He struggles with the demands of commentary and the new lifestyle that comes with it.

Addiction and Rehabilitation

The pressures of fame and personal challenges lead Wasim to develop a cocaine dependence. His wife Huma compels him to seek rehabilitation, yet his experience at the facility proves to be harsh and unhelpful, ultimately leading to his emotional turmoil.

Huma's Illness and Death

Huma falls seriously ill, and despite attempts to secure better medical care, she is diagnosed with a rare fungal infection. Tragically, she passes away, leaving Wasim to confront deep feelings of grief as well as the complexities of mourning in his culture.

The Aftermath of Loss

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Wasim struggles with his new reality as a single father to Tahmoor and Akbar while facing public scrutiny related to his personal life. He contemplates divorce and finds solace in rekindling connections with friends.

A New Connection

In the midst of his mourning, Wasim unexpectedly reconnects with Shaniera Thompson. Initially just a friendship, their bond grows as Shaniera shows support and understanding towards him and his children.

Navigating Emotional Turbulence

As their relationship develops, Wasim grapples with the

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emotional burdens of his past, feeling unprepared for a new commitment. He acknowledges the lasting impact of Huma's death while also welcoming Shaniera's presence in his life.

Hope for the Future

Ultimately, Wasim recognizes the importance of Shaniera in his life. In a poignant moment, he expresses his desire to share his journey with her, indicating a potential for healing and moving forward together with their shared responsibilities.

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Chapter 15 Summary : 15 A new beginning

CHAPTER 15: A NEW BEGINNING

Overview of Wasim Akram's Legacy

Wasim Akram, a cricket legend, continues to inspire young left-arm bowlers. His insights on swing bowling and personal experiences are revered in cricket communities.

Life with Shaniera

Shaniera, Akram's Australian wife, immersed herself in Pakistani culture upon returning to Pakistan. Their relationship faced scrutiny and media attention, particularly around their wedding, which was an impromptu and modest affair.

Personal and Collective Challenges

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The 2014 IPL was marked by personal loss as Akram's father passed away. Additionally, the tragedy at a Peshawar school emphasized the challenges faced in Pakistan's socio-political climate. Akram reflects on parenting in a troubled world while emphasizing the need for resilience.

Changing Cricket Landscape

Akram notes the transformation in cricket, particularly with the rise of T20, and laments the neglect of four-day cricket, which he believes is essential for developing well-rounded players. He acknowledges the evolution of left-arm fast bowlers and the increased competition among them.

Reflections and Future Aspirations

Akram reflects on his career with a sense of satisfaction despite challenges. He expresses optimism for his future and is committed to his children's education and well-being, highlighting the significant cultural differences in their upbringing compared to his own.

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Conclusion

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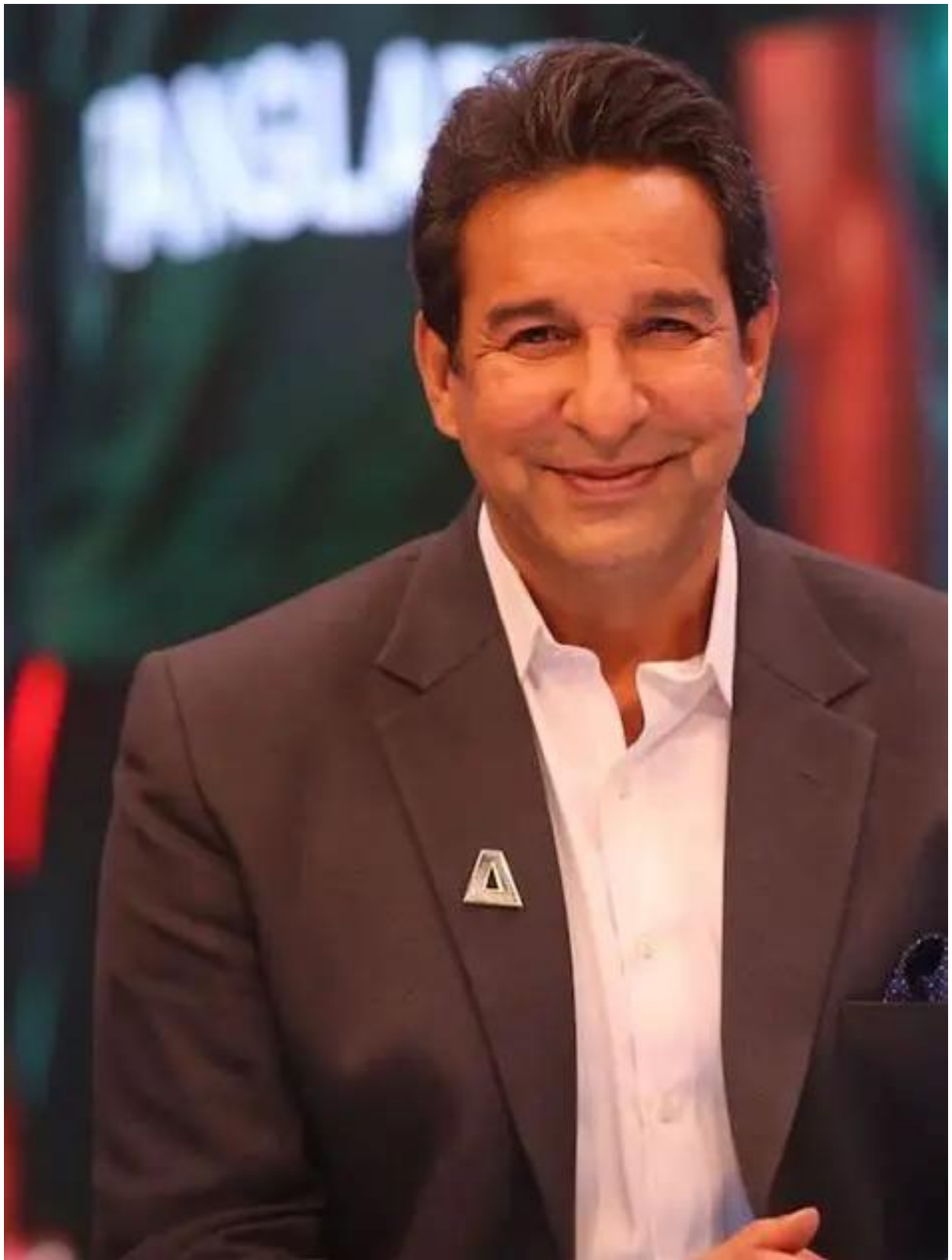
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Best Quotes from Sultan by Wasim Akram with Page Numbers

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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 382-407

- 1.He was my first hero.
- 2.Cricket, of the six-a-side variety with a tape ball, became my great outlet.
- 3.‘You’ve got something. You could be a cricketer.’
- 4.I started to get noticed. I could feel my progress.
- 5.When you’re young, every setback feels like the end.
- 6.And for a young fast bowler, this was a very good thing.

Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 408-430

- 1.‘We must work on your fast bowling muscles.’
- 2.‘The whole point of bowling is to sow doubt in the batsman’s mind.’
- 3.‘Work builds skill. Most of all, Imran tutored me in reverse swing.’

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4. 'Courage and charisma,' it said next to my picture on the front of Pakistan Cricketer. What? It was time to move up a little in the world.

5. 'You have to respect fast bowlers.'

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 431-453

1. Everything about him was completely natural.

2. What I taught him was the art of taking wickets and the importance of self-discipline.

3. But as far as the players were concerned, 'Cricket for Peace' was actually more than an empty slogan.

4. I could hardly believe I had been asked, and so far ahead of time.

5. If you were playing, you always felt he rated you.

6. There was a feeling of destiny about what we were doing.

7. This is your last warning.

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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 454-473

1. 'I can't relax', I would say. 'I'm not built that way.'
2. In Pakistan, I was accustomed to wandering round in whatever I wanted to wear; at Lancashire, the expectation was a navy blue jacket and red rose tie every day.
3. I was determined to go beyond my experience at Burnopfield and become part of my teammates' social circle, so when a Pakistani friend began bringing delicacies to the dressing room I would share them.
4. 'Will you help me improve my English?', He said, 'Sure, providing you help me learn Punjabi.'
5. Looking back, I think that this Nehru Cup, now long forgotten, was one of our most remarkable and auspicious achievements as a team.

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 474-495

1. 'Why can't I bowl round the wicket to a left-hander?'
2. 'Pick your shots', he said. 'Play straight. Don't slog.'



3. For the first time in my life I felt more than a tailender who could hit. I was confident of my defence. On that bedrock I could build.
4. Had Mushtaq Ahmed accepted a return chance from Dean Jones on the last day, we might even have squared the series.
5. I sensed Hick was vulnerable to the yorker – a tall man, he stood with his bat off the ground.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 496-524

1. The smiling, gentleman assassin was in a class of his own.
2. We need to win two of our next three games.', he argued.
'And when we play New Zealand in New Zealand, we know we can beat them.
3. Leave it to God,' Imran told us, 'and we will be all right.
4. Attack was now our watchword.
5. I felt fresh. I felt relaxed. I felt like I could fly.





Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 525-558

1. 'I'm often asked, 'What is your all-time greatest team?' I start with Akram and go from there.'

David Lloyd

2. 'I'm confident that if Wasim says he is injured, then he is injured.' Khalid Mahmood

3. 'It's your quick arm action that unsettles batsmen. You're a fast bowler. I want you to bowl quick.' Javed Miandad

4. 'There is nothing quite like beating England at Lord's.'

5. 'When we chose our team for the West Indies tour... I had spotted Aamer Nazir bowling at a pre-tour camp, and liked his turn of speed.'

6. 'I took twenty-five wickets in three Tests at 17, including my best Test figures - seven for 119 off thirty-seven overs at Wellington.'

7. 'Imran's advice, as ever, was that the cornered tiger attacks: 'Don't worry. Fine them.'

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8. 'I was trying to be a disciplinarian, without really knowing how. I was trying really to be Imran, without anything like Imran's aura and background.'

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 559-582

1. Only an elite few bowlers forced you into the mindset of surviving, rather than dominating.
2. More Pakistani cricket careers have suffered for a want of advice than a want of talent.
3. The only way, Huma counselled me, was to regard them not as friends, still less as allies, but simply as 'colleagues'.
4. I made 64 off forty-seven balls, putting on 34 with Ian and 69 with Chooky. We had a massive night's celebration, which ended with the cathedral lights blazing.
5. It's quite possible that our then captain was the outstanding batter in the world in 1994; nobody was more composed against Warne, who had just emerged as the world's best spinner.

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Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 583-609

1. I had failed as captain the first time round. I had let the position get to me. I had tried, really, to be someone I wasn't, overcompensating for my insecurities by posing as a disciplinarian, a strong man.
2. The Qur'an itself teaches that, 'whoever pardons and makes reconciliation – his reward is [due], from Allah'.
3. I accepted Aamir Sohail as vice-captain with misgivings, but was glad to have the placid Intikhab back as team manager. That would leave most of the coaching and selection to me.
4. In all the debate about whether fast bowlers can make good captains, critics ignore a key reality – the opportunity we have to lead by example.
5. We had gone from a shocking rabble to one of the favourites for the World Cup, which we were not only defending but co-hosting, with India and Sri Lanka.



6.As soon as the match was lost, Pakistan TV began playing mournful sitar tunes – the way that one might on the death of a great leader.



Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 610-639

1. 'Sometimes, childhood friends don't evolve, and you have to see that you've outgrown them.
Reserve your respect for people who work hard.'
2. 'I was angry, in fact, that that World Cup quarter-final loomed ever larger despite my not even having played in it.'
3. 'You appear to be very unpopular among your teammates. Why?'
4. 'What am I and my family going through? That doesn't seem to matter.'
5. 'The problem with the inquiry was that it became a matter of one word against another.'

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 640-662

1. 'We are going there to better the relations between the two countries, and I hope the Indian government will not allow a handful of people to deprive cricket lovers of some action and tension-packed cricket.'

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2. 'Remember to be sportsmanlike in victory.'
3. 'Perhaps, I should consider myself lucky to have played so many.'
4. 'There cannot be too many fielders in history who've felt exactly as I did in that moment, knowing that everyone in one country was willing me to catch... what everyone in another country was willing me to drop.'
5. 'Were we on the brink of something special?'

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 663-688

1. When you play against someone of that calibre, it lifts your game as well, and the experience stays with you forever.
2. I'll buy one myself one day, I said, then got up and left.
3. We were playing with confidence – maybe even overconfidence.
4. Winning is nice, but losing will always be useful to some.





Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 689-715

1. 'What are you doing here?', I asked. 'The brigadier told me,' he said meekly. So I took our manager aside. 'You might be a brigadier', I told him, 'but this is not a war and I am the captain. Leave the cricket to me.'
2. I could see the writing on the wall now.
3. My time was passing.
4. It was as though she could see round corners.
5. I was struck by what Qayyum says in relation to the chief charge, that I offered Ata money to bowl badly in the Christchurch ODI: The first allegation was prima facie the strongest against Wasim Akram. However, having considered the entire evidence, on record, this commission has come to the conclusion that Ata-ur-Rehman, in view of his retraction from his earlier statement and various subsequent statements, cannot be believed with any degree of certainty.



6.Huma was encouraging me all the time to think past cricket. It would not always be there. It might not always define me.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 716-741

1.My future is somewhere else after September.

Maybe I will be working in television or coaching.

There are no regrets. There have been ups and downs, but I would not have changed it for anything else.

2.When you start, always have an end in mind.

3.Huma's last selfless, unconscious act was curing me of my drug problem. That way of life was over, and I have never looked back.

4.But I also enjoyed Shaniera's company, so I next invited her to the 2010 Champions Trophy in South Africa.

5.I don't want to do this alone. And I don't want to do this without you.

Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 742-758

1.‘Don't go psycho on me.’

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2.'If you can play four-day cricket, you can do anything, from T20 to Test cricket.'

3.'An education is the greatest gift you can give any child.'

4.'We needed it, to be honest.'

5.'About the setbacks and scandals, I no longer harbor any particular bitterness.'

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Sultan Questions

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Chapter 1 | 1 The boy from the British Government| Q&A

1.Question

What role did Wasim Akram play in inspiring young cricketers like Pat Cummins?

Answer: Wasim Akram served as a bowling coach, sharing his expertise and infectious love for pace bowling. His ability to swing the ball and his impressive career inspired young bowlers to develop their skills and passion for cricket.

2.Question

How did the author's father influence his early life and values?

Answer: The author describes his father as a quiet and patient man who embodied reliability. His father's work ethic, his quiet strength, and the traditional values instilled in him

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shaped the author's character, teaching him resilience and hard work.

3.Question

What effect did the division of Pakistan and the subsequent family turmoil have on the author?

Answer:The turmoil surrounding his parents' separation and the economic challenges they faced caused a sense of instability in his early life. This phase forced him to adapt quickly, find refuge in outdoor play, and discover his passion for cricket amidst financial struggles.

4.Question

What was the significance of the street cricket team named 'The British Government'?

Answer:Calling their team 'The British Government' symbolized their aspiration for power and respect in their local cricket games. It also reflects how the imprint of colonialism lingered in their identity, which they believed might intimidate opponents.

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5.Question

How did the author's experience with cricket clubs change his perception of himself?

Answer:After being encouraged to play with a real cricket ball at a club, the author began to see himself as a potential cricketer rather than just a street player. This opportunity opened doors for him, validating his talent and ambition to pursue cricket seriously.

6.Question

What personal qualities helped the author excel in cricket, despite his humble beginnings?

Answer:Resilience, determination, and an unwavering passion for cricket were key qualities that fueled the author's rise. Even after setbacks, such as a severe motorcycle accident, his commitment to practice and improve never waned.

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7.Question

In what ways did his early experiences in cricket prepare him for future challenges?

Answer:Playing cricket on the streets and being mentored by older neighborhood players instilled in him crucial skills, competitive spirit, and the ability to cope with failure, which ultimately set the foundation for his professional cricket career.

8.Question

What lesson can be derived from the author's transition from a small boy in Pakistan to becoming an international cricketer?

Answer:The author's journey teaches that despite humble beginnings and numerous challenges, persistence, hard work, and seizing opportunities can lead to extraordinary achievements. It highlights the power of dreams and the importance of believing in oneself.

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9.Question

What overarching theme is evident in the author's upbringing and early cricket experiences?

Answer: The theme of resilience and the pursuit of one's passion through adversity is prevalent throughout the author's early life. His narrative emphasizes how passion for a craft, supported by dedication and opportunity, can lead to greatness.

10.Question

How did cultural background influence the author's early education and sports involvement?

Answer: Growing up in a Punjabi-speaking household where cricket was a celebrated sport, his cultural background led him to embrace cricket at a young age, closely following the legacy of great players like Imran Khan and striving to follow in their footsteps.

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Chapter 2 | 2 The guru| Q&A

1.Question

What qualities made Wasim Akram stand out as a cricketer in 1985?

Answer: Wasim Akram was a versatile bowler who could bowl various styles, had an outstanding yorker, and possessed a skiddy bouncer. His exceptional reading of batsmen and disciplined approach to fitness also set him apart.

2.Question

How did Imran Khan influence Akram's approach to bowling and training?

Answer: Imran Khan acted as a mentor, emphasizing the importance of fitness and hard work. He guided Akram in refining his bowling technique, enhancing his pivot, and teaching him the craft of reverse swing, which would become a signature aspect of Akram's bowling style.

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3.Question

What impact did the training and guidance from Imran have on Akram's early career?

Answer:Imran Khan's mentorship significantly improved Akram's skills, leading to remarkable performances, including his first match at the Melbourne Cricket Ground where he took 5 wickets for 21 runs. Akram learned effective bowling strategies that would revolutionize his game.

4.Question

In what ways did Akram's first major experiences in international cricket shape his career?

Answer:Competing in the World Championship of Cricket introduced Akram to the evolving format of one-day cricket, where he gained exposure to high-pressure matches and learned the nuances of bowling to international batsmen, shaping his approach and mental resilience as a cricketer.

5.Question

What is reverse swing, and why was it important for

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Akram's bowling style?

Answer: Reverse swing is a technique used with an old cricket ball that allows it to swing in the opposite direction of conventional swing by emphasizing the difference in shine between the two sides. It became crucial for Akram as it added an extra weapon to his already versatile bowling arsenal.

6.Question

What role did Akram's relationships with his teammates play in his development as a cricketer?

Answer: Akram's relationships with teammates, including mutual respect and mentorship, fostered a supportive environment that encouraged learning and skill development. For instance, his friendship with Dean Jones evolved from fierce competition to camaraderie.

7.Question

How did Akram's experience in Sharjah solidify his place in cricket history?

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Answer: Akram's performance in the Australasia Cup Final against India, where he showcased his ability under pressure and contributed to a historic victory, solidified his reputation as not just a cricketer but a national hero, fueling his growth and establishing his legacy in Pakistani cricket.

8.Question

Reflecting on Akram's journey, what lessons can be drawn about mentorship in sports?

Answer: Akram's journey illustrates that mentorship can tremendously impact an individual's development in sports. The dedication of a mentor, like Imran Khan, not only transfers skills but also instills professional discipline, resilience, and the confidence necessary to perform at the highest levels.

9.Question

How did Akram's mindset evolve in terms of competition and pressure during big matches?

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Answer:Initially, Akram felt fear and uncertainty in high-stakes games, but under Imran's mentorship, he learned to thrive under pressure, focusing on strategy and execution rather than the fear of failure, which became instrumental in his successful career.

10.Question

What place does camaraderie have in Akram's narrative about cricket?

Answer:Camaraderie among players, as seen in Akram's relationships with teammates, highlighted the importance of unity and support, which were crucial for team dynamics and collective success, particularly in challenging and high-pressure matches.

Chapter 3 | 3 Imran, Viv and me| Q&A

1.Question

What does Viv Richards imply about Wasim Akram's talent compared to his own experience in cricket?

Answer:Viv Richards emphasizes that Wasim

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Akram's talent was entirely natural and unaltered, unlike his own, which required a complete reconstruction of his action early in his career. Richards admires Akram's innate capabilities and passion for cricket, suggesting that he saw Akram as an exceptionally gifted cricketer, comparable to or possibly surpassing any in the world.

2.Question

How did Wasim's experience and training under Imran Khan shape his career?

Answer:Imran Khan taught Wasim the significance of self-discipline and how to take wickets effectively. This mentorship with a focus on hard work and fulfilling his potential was pivotal for Wasim's growth, enabling him to rise to the top of the cricketing world.

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3.Question

Discuss the significance of 'Cricket for Peace' in the backdrop of Pakistan-India relations. What lessons can be drawn?

Answer: The 'Cricket for Peace' policy highlighted the power of sports as a diplomatic tool during a time of military tension between India and Pakistan. It showcases how cricket served not only as entertainment but also as a means to foster goodwill and camaraderie, illustrating that sports can bridge divides and promote unity.

4.Question

What was the impact of Wasim's performance in India during the Test series mentioned?

Answer: Wasim's impressive bowling, including taking five wickets in Kolkata and showcasing his speed, significantly contributed to Pakistan's eventual success in the series. His performance not only boosted his confidence but also helped solidify Pakistan's competitive edge during this tense period.

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5.Question

How did the camaraderie and interactions between players from India and Pakistan during the tour reflect on the broader socio-political context?

Answer: Despite the political tensions, the joyful interactions during festivities like Holi revealed the potential for sports to foster friendship and mutual respect. This points to a deeper truth: shared experiences in sports can transcend political narratives and allow for human connections.

6.Question

Describe the differences in the reception between the Pakistani cricket team and their experiences in England compared to India. What does this indicate about cultural perceptions?

Answer: In England, the Pakistani team faced hostility from English fans and had a far less welcoming environment than the warm receptions they enjoyed in India. This contrast illustrates the cultural differences in how sportsmanship and

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national pride manifest, where cricket sometimes becomes a battleground for historical grievances.

7.Question

What was the significance of Imran Khan's leadership style, especially in the context of the Pakistani team's morale?

Answer:Imran Khan's commanding leadership instilled confidence and a unified spirit within the team. His ability to motivate and mentor his players, like Wasim, created a cohesive unit capable of overcoming challenges, leading to significant victories and highs in their cricketing endeavors.

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8.Question

How did Wasim Akram's evolving bowling style and approach reflect his growth as a cricketer?

Answer: Akram's experimentation with his run-up and the confidence to adjust his technique highlight his adaptability and continuous improvement as a player.

Under Imran's encouragement and mentorship, he developed a unique bowling style that contributed to his success and eventually earned him respect as one of the greats.

9.Question

Reflect on how the experience and lessons from competitive tours shaped Wasim Akram's future in cricket. What can current athletes learn from this?

Answer: Wasim Akram's journeys through high-pressure situations and competitive rivalries honed his skills and mental resilience. Current athletes can learn about the importance of adaptability, learning from experiences, and

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maintaining a growth mindset to achieve success in sports and beyond.

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Chapter 4 | 4 Wasim for England| Q&A

1.Question

What inspired Wasim Akram to push beyond his limits while playing for Lancashire?

Answer: Wasim Akram's competitive nature and determination to excel in cricket motivated him to work harder, even in unfamiliar surroundings. He brought his training regime from Pakistan, focusing on perfecting his reverse swing techniques, and despite his teammates' bemusement, he dedicated himself to running laps and bowling indoors when others suggested he relax. His commitment to success, exemplified by his maiden first-class century and impressive bowling statistics, showcased his relentless pursuit of improvement.

2.Question

How did Wasim Akram adapt to the cultural differences he faced in England?

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Answer: Wasim Akram faced cultural contrasts, particularly between the social structures of county cricket in England and domestic cricket in Pakistan. He embraced new norms, such as wearing the appropriate attire and engaging with teammates regularly at the bar. He also worked on his English, making friends across cultural lines and integrating into the English way of life while maintaining respect for his own cultural values.

3.Question

What role did friendship and community play in Akram's early career at Lancashire?

Answer: The camaraderie among teammates at Lancashire provided a supportive environment for Wasim Akram. He engaged with them socially, sharing meals, learning English, and trusting them for guidance. Their light-hearted teasing and joint ventures in training and off-field activities helped him to bond with the team, easing his transition into English cricket and fostering a sense of belonging.

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4.Question

What lessons did Wasim Akram learn about teamwork and support while playing cricket?

Answer: Throughout his experiences in county cricket, Wasim Akram learned the importance of teamwork, where mutual support among players significantly contributes to success. The culture at Lancashire emphasized time spent together, both on and off the field. Akram realized that cricket is not just about individual skill but also about building relationships that enhance team performance.

5.Question

How did personal struggles influence Wasim Akram's character development?

Answer: Wasim Akram faced personal struggles, such as injuries and being away from home, which challenged his resilience. He learned to navigate these difficulties through establishing his independence in England, managing domestic life, and maintaining his focus on cricket amidst

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distractions. These experiences ultimately shaped him into a more adaptable and strong-willed individual.

6.Question

What was the significance of Akram's experiences in England for his identity as a cricketer?

Answer:Playing in England critically shaped Wasim Akram's identity as a cricketer, introducing him to new levels of competition and camaraderie. His success there, including making record performances and forming impactful partnerships, elevated his stature not just in Pakistan but in the international cricket scene, allowing him to bridge cultural gaps and inspire future generations.

7.Question

What did the nickname 'King' signify for Wasim Akram at Lancashire?

Answer:The nickname 'King' symbolized Wasim Akram's growing stature and the affection his teammates felt for him. Despite the embarrassment it caused him at times, it reflected

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his impact on the team and his emerging confidence in his cricketing abilities as he forged deeper connections with his peers.

8.Question

How did Wasim Akram manage the balance between cricket and personal relationships?

Answer: Wasim Akram balanced cricket and personal relationships through intentional efforts to prioritize both aspects of his life. His determination to spend time with Huma despite the demands of his training required careful logistical planning as he traveled extensively for games. This commitment to nurturing his relationship while excelling in cricket illustrated his dedication and the enriching power of love in enhancing performance.

9.Question

Which moment stood out for Wasim Akram during his early career and why?

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Answer: A standout moment for Wasim Akram was his performance during the Champions Trophy when he achieved a hat-trick and contributed significantly to the team's victories. This not only marked a personal achievement but also solidified his growing reputation as a formidable fast bowler, showcasing his potential to impact the game positively.

Chapter 5 | 5 An all-rounder at last| Q&A

1.Question

What lessons does Wasim Akram highlight about adapting to different playing conditions in cricket?

Answer: He emphasizes the importance of experimentation and adaptability, citing his experiences with varying techniques in county cricket, particularly while bowling to different batsmen. He learned to bowl round the wicket to left-handers and to utilize pace variations, highlighting that one cannot just rely on a single tactic. Akram saw

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this adaptability as essential in overcoming his own limitations and succeeding against different opponents.

2.Question

How does Wasim Akram describe his relationship with Imran Khan during their cricketing careers?

Answer: Akram portrays Imran Khan as a crucial mentor and guide, as well as a source of inspiration. Imran not only advised him on techniques and strategies but also instilled in him a sense of confidence and discipline, shaping him into a more rounded cricketer. Their on-field partnership and mutual respect contributed to Akram's growth and success.

3.Question

What impact did Akram's experiences in county cricket have on his overall cricketing abilities?

Answer: His time in county cricket was transformative; he learned to balance bowling and batting, leading to becoming an all-rounder. The exposure to consistent matches and the

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pressure of performing under various conditions allowed him to develop his skills significantly. He became more versatile in his approach and gained a deeper understanding of the game.

4.Question

What does Akram suggest about the relationship between personality and sporting success?

Answer: Akram illustrates that personality plays a significant role in sporting success, citing examples of his peers. He contrasts players like Saleem Malik, whose talent was overshadowed by personality flaws, with Desmond Haynes, whose bravery and character made him a respected leader. Akram argues that a good personality combined with talent is vital for lasting success in sports.

5.Question

How does Wasim Akram reflect on the pressures and expectations faced by cricketers?

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Answer:He acknowledges that the pressures, especially for overseas players, can be immense. As an individual seeking to excel while representing his country, he felt anxious not to let his supporters down. His reflections reveal the burdens of expectation and the impact they had on his performance and mental state during critical matches.

6.Question

What does Akram say about his evolution as a player through injuries and challenges?

Answer:Akram discusses how his injuries, while daunting, forced him to adapt and innovate his technique through remedial measures and more strategic thinking. His willingness to seek help and improve upon his weaknesses highlights his tenacity and commitment to continuous growth, which are key attributes for success in sports.

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Chapter 6 | 6 1992 and all that| Q&A

1.Question

What qualities made Wasim Akram the best bowler according to the author?

Answer: Wasim Akram was a left-arm fast bowler known for his exceptional speed and the ability to swing the ball both ways. He had a brutal bouncer, immaculate line and length, and was described as a competitive animal, making it extremely difficult for batsmen to score against him.

2.Question

How did Imran Khan influence the team's mindset during the World Cup?

Answer: Imran Khan instilled a sense of purpose and mission in the team. He emphasized that they were not just playing for victory, but also for a greater cause, inspiring the team with his dedication to building a cancer hospital in Lahore.

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3.Question

Despite the team's struggles at the beginning of the World Cup, how did they find motivation?

Answer:The team maintained a buoyancy and youthful spirit despite early setbacks. The coaching from Imran Khan, the excitement of touring Australia, and a belief in their potential fostered a sense of optimism as they trained together and bonded as a team.

4.Question

What role did faith and belief play in the team's journey during the World Cup?

Answer:Faiith played a significant role, with the team fasting during Ramadan and praying together for success. They believed that their efforts, coupled with divine support, could turn their fortunes around in the tournament.

5.Question

How did Huma support the author in preparing for the final match?

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Answer:Huma played a crucial role by helping the author practice mental conditioning techniques. She encouraged him to focus on positive visualization, breathing, and body language, which helped him feel relaxed and confident before the final.

6.Question

What pivotal moment in the final match shifted the momentum towards Pakistan's victory?

Answer:A pivotal moment occurred when Imran Khan, despite struggling, managed to top-edge a catch that was dropped by Gooch. This moment sparked a significant acceleration in the team's scoring and shifted the game in their favor.

7.Question

How did the players react after the victory in the World Cup final?

Answer:After winning the World Cup final, the joyous team sank to their knees in relief and gratitude. They celebrated

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exuberantly with the song 'Allah Hoo' and reveled in the overwhelming support from fans and the honor of bringing the trophy home.

8.Question

What was the public's reaction to the team's victory in Pakistan?

Answer:The public's reaction was overwhelming, with thousands of well-wishers greeting the team upon their return. The celebration was monumental, symbolizing national pride and unity, as the players were paraded and showered with gifts and accolades.

9.Question

Reflecting on Imran Khan's leadership after the World Cup, what was his vision moving forward?

Answer:After the World Cup victory, Imran Khan's vision shifted towards philanthropy, notably focusing on the completion of the Shaukat Khanum hospital. He began

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distancing himself from cricket, indicating a transition to larger ambitions beyond the sport.

10.Question

How did the success at the World Cup impact the players' careers and future paths?

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Answer: The success at the World Cup solidified the players' status as heroes in Pakistan, shaping their careers and future paths in cricket. It also created a rift between Imran Khan and some senior players, indicating a shift in dynamics within the team moving forward.

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Chapter 7 | 7 A reluctant captain| Q&A

1.Question

What lessons can we draw from Wasim Akram's experience with team dynamics and leadership?

Answer: Wasim Akram illustrates the complexities of team relationships and leadership. His experience shows that understanding individual personalities, nurturing cooperation, and actively managing conflicts are crucial for a cohesive team. As a captain, he learned that being authoritative sometimes alienates others. Fostering an environment of respect, patience, and communication can enhance unity and performance.

2.Question

How did Wasim Akram handle his injury and what does this say about resilience?

Answer: During the World Cup, Akram faced skepticism from Javed Miandad regarding his injury. Nevertheless, he

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displayed resilience by seeking medical help, showing commitment to the team, and ultimately proving his worth through his performance despite his setback. This underscores the importance of advocating for oneself and seeking support in challenging circumstances.

3.Question

What role did Khalid Mahmood play in Akram's recovery and team morale?

Answer:Khalid Mahmood showcased exceptional leadership skills by supporting Akram during his injury, advocating for him to Javed Miandad, and ensuring he received proper care. His actions contributed positively to Akram's morale and recovery, demonstrating how a supportive management can significantly influence a player's resilience and performance.

4.Question

What impact did the England series have on Akram's confidence and skills as a captain?

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Answer: The series against England not only boosted Akram's confidence following some remarkable performances but also provided him with a platform to experiment with his leadership style. It marked his evolution from a hesitant player into a more assertive captain, enhancing his tactical acumen and decision-making skills under pressure.

5.Question

How did the cultural dynamics within the team contribute to their overall performance during tours?

Answer: The cultural dynamics within the team created a bonding atmosphere, but also led to underlying tensions, as seen in the conflicts and disagreements over bonuses and leadership roles. This duality influenced their overall performance—while camaraderie led to moments of triumph, unresolved conflicts often resulted in instability. Akram's reflections teach us the value of managing both the competitive spirit and relationships within a diverse group.

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6.Question

How did Akram's personal life influence his professional career and leadership?

Answer: Akram's personal life, especially his relationship with Huma, was a source of emotional support that bolstered his confidence on the field. Her presence and encouragement helped him draw on resilience and self-belief during challenging times, illustrating how personal stability can enhance professional performance and decision-making in leadership roles.

7.Question

What did the controversies around ball tampering reveal about perceptions of Pakistani cricket? Answer: The ball tampering controversies reflected longstanding biases and stereotypes against Pakistani players, illustrating how nationality can color perceptions in sports. Despite Akram and Waqar's triumphs, the allegations of cheating highlighted the challenges of overcoming structural assumptions in

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international cricket, emphasizing the importance of integrity and professionalism.

8.Question

What strategies did Akram employ to ensure his team's success amidst challenges?

Answer: Akram implemented strategies such as close communication, fostering team bonding through shared experiences, notably leveraging the skills of individual players, and staying resolute amidst conflicts. His attempts to involve senior players in decision-making were crucial in addressing dissent and fostering a more united front.

9.Question

How did Wasim Akram's captaincy contribute to the historical context of Pakistani cricket?

Answer: Akram's captaincy marked a pivotal transition in Pakistani cricket, especially post-Imran Khan's era. His leadership faced criticisms but also bred a new generation of players and strategies that aimed at establishing Pakistan as a

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formidable force in cricket, contributing to its rich history of resilience and talent.

10.Question

What does Akram's story tell us about dealing with pressure and expectations?

Answer: Akram's journey underscores the vital importance of mental resilience when facing immense pressure and expectations as a successful athlete. His ability to compartmentalize personal struggles, maintain focus on cricket, and rise to the occasion demonstrates the importance of mental fortitude and self-belief in achieving both individual and team success.

11.Question

What insights can we gain from Akram's reflections on mentorship and legacy?

Answer: Akram's leadership style evolved significantly over time and he often reflected on the mentorship he received. His experiences emphasize the importance of legacy in

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sports; how seasoned professionals can inspire and shape the futures of younger players. This mentoring aspect highlights how collective growth strengthens the team's foundation for lasting success.

Chapter 8 | 8 Dirty money| Q&A

1.Question

How did Wasim Akram's style of bowling impact his opponents?

Answer: Wasim Akram's bowling style was characterized by stealth, skill, strength, and stamina, creating a mindset among batsmen of constantly being on the defensive rather than settling in to dominate. His exceptional technique allowed him to bowl with intense speed and movement, making him one of the most intimidating bowlers in cricket history.

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2.Question

What initial experience indicated to Wasim Akram that corruption existed in cricket?

Answer:Before the Austral-Asia Cup final in April 1990, Akram heard rumors that the team would lose to Australia. Imran Khan, the captain, addressed the team about these rumors, illustrating the dark undercurrents of corruption in sports, especially in Pakistan.

3.Question

What advice did Imran Khan give to Wasim Akram regarding team integrity?

Answer:Imran Khan advised Akram to focus solely on his performance and to avoid becoming embroiled in any rumors or allegations of fixing. He emphasized the importance of maintaining one's reputation by ensuring that nobody could claim he wasn't trying.

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4.Question

What were the dynamics within the Pakistani cricket team during Akram's career?

Answer: The dynamics shifted significantly throughout Akram's career, especially as leadership changed and players became more self-focused. A lack of unity and rising tensions were evident, particularly after Imran retired and Javed Miandad was sidelined, leading to a team atmosphere fraught with distrust.

5.Question

How did Akram cope with feelings of being an outsider within the team?

Answer: Wasim Akram coped by distancing himself emotionally from his teammates, seeing them more as colleagues rather than friends. He contributed his skills without engaging fully, building a protective wall between himself and the personal conflicts within the team.

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6.Question

What does Akram suggest is a risk for athletes regarding their personal relationships?

Answer:He suggests that often, the individuals closest to them—like family and friends—can be just as dangerous as ill-wishers when it comes to navigating corrupt environments. Trusting long-term acquaintances can lead to a susceptibility to negative influences.

7.Question

What lessons can be derived from the tumultuous relationship between players in the national team?

Answer:The tumultuous relationships show the importance of integrity and unity in a team. Personal ambitions can cloud judgment, and without strong leadership and mutual respect, a team can fall prey to chaos and disarray.

8.Question

What pivotal moment illustrated the impact of corruption in cricket for Akram?

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Answer: During the third test against Zimbabwe, allegations surfaced that teammate Saleem Malik had offered bribes to underperform during matches, showcasing the deep-seated issues of integrity that plagued the sport.

9.Question

What coping strategy did Akram's wife, Huma, provide him amidst the team's discord?

Answer: Huma encouraged Akram to view his teammates as simply colleagues, helping him to navigate the emotional turmoil and distance himself from the personal conflicts affecting team dynamics.

10.Question

How did Akram's performance in international matches reflect on his inner struggles?

Answer: Despite the chaos around him, Akram often performed exceptionally on the field, such as taking wickets and contributing to wins, reflecting his commitment to

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cricket while battling feelings of isolation and frustration off the field.

Chapter 9 | 9 Taking on the world| Q&A

1.Question

How did Wasim Akram's approach to leadership change from his first captaincy to his subsequent one?

Answer:Initially, Wasim allowed his insecurities to dictate his leadership style, trying to act like a strict disciplinarian. After reflecting on his experiences and receiving support from his wife Huma, he learned to embrace his true self and lead with maturity, aiming to be a captain in his own authentic way.

2.Question

What does Imran Khan's quote "whoever pardons and makes reconciliation – his reward is due from Allah" signify in the context of Wasim's leadership?

Answer:This quote underlines the importance of forgiveness and solidarity in team dynamics, which resonated with

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Wasim as he returned to captaincy despite previous conflicts. It marked a new beginning where reconciliation became pivotal to building a cohesive team.

3.Question

What challenges did Wasim Akram face during the Australian Test series, and how did the team respond?

Answer: The team faced significant challenges, including poor fielding that led to dropped catches and difficult playing conditions. Despite this, Wasim showcased exemplary leadership by pushing through struggles, leading by example with both bat and ball, ultimately achieving a sense of camaraderie and resilience within the squad.

4.Question

How did the pressures from both the fans and the media impact Wasim after the World Cup loss to India?

Answer: The fallout from the defeat was immense; Wasim faced public outcry, accusations of collusion with match-fixers, threats to his family, and severe criticism from

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politicians. The cultural and emotional investment in cricket in Pakistan made the loss particularly grievous for him and the team.

5.Question

What does the term 'leadership by example' mean in the context of Wasim's captaincy?

Answer:'Leadership by example' refers to Wasim's strategy of demonstrating high standards of performance with his own play, thereby inspiring and motivating his teammates. When he effectively leads with both strong bowling and effective batting, he sets a standard for others to follow.

6.Question

In what ways did Wasim's leadership improve the team's performance after they faced setbacks?

Answer:Wasim's leadership fostered a spirit of togetherness and resilience. Following initial disappointments, he motivated his players to focus on their strengths and play

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competitively, leading to significant victories, including the memorable win against Australia in Sydney.

7.Question

What lesson does Wasim Akram's experience with Aamir Sohail during the India match convey about accountability in a team setting?

Answer: Wasim's experience highlights the need for individual accountability within a team. Sohail's reckless shot exemplified a failure to manage pressure, which affected the entire team's morale and performance, demonstrating how individual actions can have broader implications.

8.Question

How did Wasim manage to turn individual talent into collective success for the Pakistani cricket team?

Answer: Wasim identified and nurtured individual talents like Mushfiquir and Afridi, fostering a collaborative environment where each player could contribute their unique skills while

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also emphasizing teamwork over individualism, thus transforming the team into a formidable unit.

9.Question

What were some significant highlights of Wasim's career as mentioned in this chapter?

Answer:Highlights include his evolution into a mature captain, leading Pakistan to victories in challenging environments, breaking personal records like taking his

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300th Test wicket, and successfully captaining during the Tri-Nation Series in Australia.

10.Question

What does Wasim mean when he states that fans in Pakistan rarely forgive failures in cricket?

Answer: Wasim's statement reflects the intense passion and emotional investment of Pakistani fans in cricket, implying that the stakes are incredibly high and that public scrutiny and expectations can be unrelenting when the team underperforms.

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Chapter 10 | 10 Under investigation| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn from Wasim Akram's experience dealing with allegations of match-fixing and trust issues with friends?

Answer: Wasim Akram's experience underscores the importance of being selective about whom we trust, especially in challenging times. It teaches us that sometimes childhood friendships may not withstand the test of personal and professional growth. As Akram suggests, we need to reserve respect for those who work hard and contribute positively to our lives, instead of clinging to old friendships that no longer serve our best interests.

2.Question

How did Akram's diagnosis of diabetes impact his career and outlook on life?

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Answer: Akram's diagnosis of type 1 diabetes was a devastating blow, as he had always relied on his physical fitness and had taken his health for granted. However, it also prompted him to take control of his life in new ways, managing his condition through diet and insulin. His ability to adapt and continue playing cricket at a high level despite this challenge showcases resilience and determination, serving as an inspiration for others facing similar struggles.

3.Question

What does Akram's story reveal about the nature of leadership and accountability?

Answer: Akram's story reveals that true leadership requires not only guiding a team but also being accountable for one's own actions and decisions. Throughout his experiences with the PCB (Pakistan Cricket Board) and fellow teammates, he highlights the failure of leaders to provide support and uphold integrity, especially in the face of corruption allegations. Effective leaders take responsibility and protect

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their team's morale rather than shift blame or act in self-interest.

4.Question

What lessons can young athletes take from Akram's views on childhood friends and maturity?

Answer: Young athletes can learn that not all relationships will grow as they do and that it is essential to recognize when friendships become unbalanced. Akram advises that it's important to surround oneself with those who uplift rather than drag down, indicating that maturity often involves reassessing personal relationships and making difficult choices for one's wellbeing.

5.Question

In what ways did Akram manage his diabetes while continuing to perform as an athlete?

Answer: Akram managed his diabetes by educating himself about the condition—understanding the importance of diet, insulin management, and listening to his body's signals. His

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commitment to monitoring his blood sugar levels, planning meals, and ensuring his health needs were met is a powerful example of how athletes can adapt to health challenges without compromising their performance.

6.Question

What role did Akram's mental health play during the investigations and accusations he faced?

Answer: Akram's mental health significantly deteriorated during the investigations and accusations, leading him into deep despondency and feelings of isolation. He experienced stress that exacerbated his diabetes and contributed to a sense of powerlessness. This highlights the overarching impact that mental well-being can have on physical health and performance, especially under public scrutiny and pressure.

7.Question

How did Akram's experiences shape his views on teamwork and trust within a cricket team?

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Answer: Akram's experiences shaped him to be more wary of whom he could trust within the team's dynamics, emphasizing that trust must be earned and not taken for granted. He learned that effective teamwork requires open communication, shared values, and unwavering support for one another, especially in difficult circumstances.

8.Question

What ultimately drove Akram to resume leadership in the cricket team despite the allegations?

Answer: Akram was driven to resume leadership by his desire to clear his name and prove his innocence, as well as his intrinsic love for the game of cricket. His resilience to rise above challenges, motivated by a need to support his country and team, compelled him to step back into a leadership role, showing a commitment to the sport and to his fellow players.

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Chapter 11 | 11 Mission to India| Q&A

1.Question

What role did Wasim Akram play in inspiring future generations of fast bowlers?

Answer: Wasim Akram served as a monumental inspiration for fast bowlers worldwide, especially in the Subcontinent. His illustrious career coincided with the rise of better television coverage, allowing his extraordinary skills to reach countless young aspirants who dreamed of emulating his bowling style. His charismatic demeanor, competitive spirit, and the joy he exhibited while playing made him an idol for many, convincing them that fast bowling could be both an art and a source of great joy.

2.Question

How did politics impact Akram's career, particularly in the context of playing cricket in India?

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Answer: Politics played a significant role in Wasim Akram's career, particularly in hindering the opportunity for Pakistan to engage in matches in India. He reflected on the challenges posed by political tensions, which often overshadowed cricketing events, creating barriers that limited his international playing experience in India. Akram maintained a hopeful outlook for future relations, suggesting that despite past conflicts, a miraculous thaw in relations could occur, similar to the unexpected resumption of cricketing ties shortly after nuclear tests by both nations.

3.Question

Describe the significance of the 1999 World Cup and the emerging players like Shoaib Akhtar and Shahid Afridi?

Answer: The 1999 World Cup was pivotal for Pakistan cricket, marking the emergence of new talents such as Shoaib Akhtar and Shahid Afridi. Akhtar, previously struggling with consistency, found his rhythm and became a breakout star during the tournament. His speed and enthusiasm captured

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the attention of fans and selectors alike. Meanwhile, Afridi's potential began to be recognized beyond limited overs cricket, as his ability to perform under pressure and his explosive batting brought renewed excitement to the team. Their performances foreshadowed a new era in Pakistani cricket.

4.Question

Discuss the significance of Akram's leadership during the cricket tour to India in 1999.

Answer: Akram's leadership during the 1999 cricket tour to India was marked by the dual challenge of competing on the field while navigating complex political tensions. He aimed to foster goodwill and demonstrate that cricket could bridge divides between the two nations. His approach was characterized by a focus on the positives, a determination to perform under pressure, and an emphasis on sportsmanship amidst adversity. The tour, which drew significant media

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attention and featured remarkable cricketing moments, reflected the potential for sport to play a diplomatic role.

5.Question

How did the experiences in India shape Akram's perspective on cricket and diplomacy?

Answer: The experiences Akram had during his time in India shaped his belief in cricket as a vehicle for peace and understanding. Witnessing the overwhelming public interest and emotional investment in matches, he realized the sport transcended boundaries. His philosophy that cricket could foster better relations was reinforced by encounters with fans and the players on the field, highlighting the shared passion for the game. Akram's subsequent efforts to emphasize sportsmanship and positivity during challenging times illustrated his commitment to using cricket as a platform for diplomacy.

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6.Question

What was the impact of the crowd during the matches in Kolkata?

Answer:The crowd in Kolkata had a profound impact during the matches, creating an electric yet sometimes volatile atmosphere. Their passionate support for players like Sachin Tendulkar demonstrated cricket's ability to galvanize emotions and unify people, but it also revealed the intense rivalry and pressure associated with the matches. When controversial moments, such as Tendulkar's dismissal, occurred, the crowd's reaction underscored the stakes involved in the rivalry, turning the stadium into a cauldron of fervor that reflected broader societal sentiments.

7.Question

Reflect on the significance of Akram's hat-trick in consecutive Tests.

Answer:Achieving a hat-trick in consecutive Tests was a remarkable feat for Akram, showcasing his elite skills and

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capacity to perform under pressure. This accomplishment not only solidified his status as one of the premier fast bowlers of his era but also became a significant highlight in Pakistan's cricketing history. His performances served to inspire younger players and reaffirmed the effectiveness of dedication and hard work in achieving excellence in the sport.

Chapter 12 | 12 A cup forfeited| Q&A

1.Question

How did Wasim Akram's rivalry with Sachin Tendulkar elevate their performances?

Answer: Facing a player of Wasim Akram's caliber pushed Sachin Tendulkar to enhance his own game. Their matches were not just about personal scores but created a mutual respect that transcended competition, illustrating how rivalries can inspire players to reach new heights.

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2.Question

What qualities of the Pakistani team contributed to their early success before the 1999 World Cup?

Answer: The team benefited from a dynamic combination of players, with Shahid Afridi's explosiveness, Yousuf Youhana's finesse, and Azhar Mahmood's balance. Winning pre-World Cup tournaments built their confidence and unity, reflecting how teamwork and preparation lead to success.

3.Question

What role did fixing allegations play in the team's morale during the Coca-Cola Cup?

Answer: The persistent rumors of match-fixing created a tense atmosphere, undermining the team's confidence just as they were building momentum. Javed's insistence on swearing on the Qur'an highlighted the team's anxiety and affected their performance adversely.

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4.Question

How did Wasim Akram react to the allegations against his team during the tournament?

Answer:He was firm in refuting the allegations, emphasizing the need for integrity among players. His refusal to engage with corrupt offers illustrated his commitment to the sport and set a moral standard for his teammates.

5.Question

What changes did Wasim Akram implement in the team leading up to the World Cup?

Answer:Akram advocated for strategic adjustments, such as prioritizing bowlers to exploit the conditions. He also brought in new personnel like Mushtaq Mohammad and Richard Pybus to create a balanced coaching staff that focused on analysis and calm leadership.

6.Question

What significance did the match against India during the 1999 World Cup hold for Pakistan?

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Answer: The match was significant not only for the cricketing rivalry but also due to the political tensions following the Kargil conflict. Losing this match reinforced a streak of World Cup failures against India and brought emotional weight to the Pakistani team's performance.

7.Question

How did Wasim Akram's leadership style influence the team dynamics during the World Cup?

Answer: Akram's leadership fostered a supportive environment where players could flourish, but he also faced challenges when managing tensions and pressures, especially after losses that led to blame-shifting among team members. His response to setbacks highlighted the complexity of leading under stress.

8.Question

What lessons can be drawn from Pakistan's World Cup final performance against Australia?

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Answer: The experience taught that pressure can disrupt even the best strategies. Maintaining focus and composure is crucial in high-stakes moments, and the final underscored the importance of preparation and adaptability in cricket.

9.Question

What were the consequences for the team following the World Cup loss?

Answer: The aftermath included scrutiny from the PCB, leading to various suspensions and investigations that threatened to overshadow their previous successes. This situation highlighted the fragile nature of trust and reputation in professional sports.

10.Question

How did personal integrity play a role in Wasim Akram's

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actions during the controversies?

Answer: Akram's firm refusal of gifts and his public stance against corruption illustrated his dedication to maintaining integrity in cricket. He believed in personal accountability, which served as a guiding principle during tumultuous times in the sport.

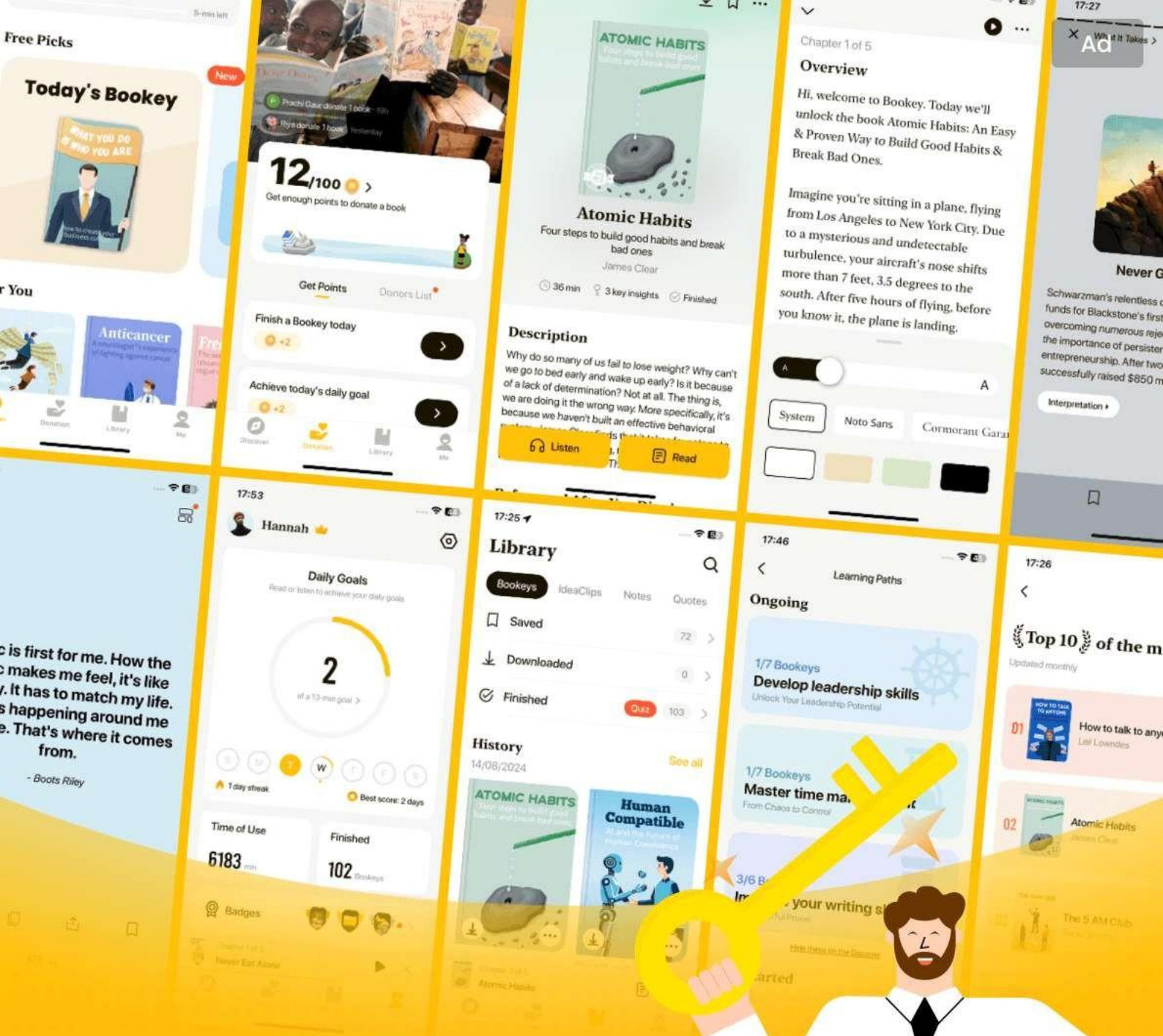
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Chapter 13 | 13 General disarray| Q&A

1.Question

What makes Wasim Akram regarded as one of the greatest fast bowlers?

Answer: Wasim Akram is celebrated for his exceptional pace, left-arm angle, quick arm action, and ability to deliver reverse swing. His versatility and skill allowed him to bowl effectively in various conditions, making him a formidable opponent on the field.

2.Question

How did political and managerial changes within the PCB affect the team dynamics?

Answer: The appointment of Lt Gen Tauqir Zia as chairman led to significant upheaval, including changes in team management and coaching staff. This created a toxic environment, fostering favoritism and divisions within the

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team, particularly favoring certain players and undermining team cohesion.

3.Question

What was the reaction to the bowling ban imposed on Shoaib Akhtar, and how did it illustrate the challenges within the PCB?

Answer: The bowling ban on Shoaib Akhtar without prior consultation created frustration within the team, highlighting the dysfunctional decision-making at the PCB. The subsequent agreement that he shouldn't bowl bouncers underscored the lack of transparency and the chaos in managing players' careers.

4.Question

What challenges did Wasim Akram face in maintaining his position as captain during the turmoil?

Answer: Wasim Akram faced opposition from rivals within the team, management interference, and the undermining of his authority as captain. Despite his efforts to lead and keep

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the team united, he found himself increasingly isolated amid political maneuvering and favoritism.

5.Question

How did Wasim Akram handle the pressure from public scrutiny and personal challenges regarding his reputation?

Answer: Akram dealt with immense pressure from media scrutiny and accusations of match-fixing by focusing on his performance. Despite feeling the weight of public disapproval and accusations, he sought to silence his critics through hard work and dedication on the field.

6.Question

What is the significance of personal integrity versus public perception, as reflected in Akram's experiences?

Answer: Akram's experiences underscore the disparity between personal integrity and public perception. Despite knowing he was innocent of match-fixing allegations, the public and media created narratives that overshadowed his

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achievements, ultimately impacting his reputation significantly.

7.Question

How did Wasim Akram's family play a role in his life during his cricketing career?

Answer:His family, particularly his wife Huma, provided crucial support, urging him to look beyond cricket. Huma's foresight about their children's future and her unwavering support during tough times formed a strong foundation for Akram, illustrating the importance of family amidst professional chaos.

8.Question

What lessons can be learned about resilience and perseverance from Wasim Akram's journey?

Answer:Akram's journey teaches resilience in the face of adversity, the importance of holding onto personal values despite external pressures, and the necessity of adaptability to navigate professional challenges. His ability to continue

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performing amidst chaos illustrates a strong commitment to his craft.

9.Question

How does the chapter depict the relationship between sports and politics?

Answer: The chapter illustrates that sports in Pakistan are deeply intertwined with politics, where managerial decisions based on political affiliations often disrupt team dynamics and performance. This reflects a broader theme of how external influences can impact athletes' careers and the integrity of the sport.

10.Question

In what ways does the chapter reflect on the notion of legacy in sports?

Answer: The chapter grapples with the complexity of legacy; Akram's contributions to cricket are overshadowed by controversy, leading to questions about how athletes are remembered. It highlights that while personal achievements

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are significant, public perception often shapes an athlete's legacy.

Chapter 14 | 14 Battling my demons| Q&A

1.Question

What does Wasim Akram express about his feeling of acceptance and adjustment after retirement from international cricket?

Answer: Wasim reflects on his retirement as a necessary acceptance of futility in continuing to play. He feels that despite his lack of official retirement, being excluded from the national team brought an end to his professional career. He battled the feelings of uselessness and sought a new identity, particularly in transitioning to playing county cricket out of hope for a comeback.

2.Question

How does Wasim's relationship with his wife, Huma, evolve during the course of his struggles with addiction?

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Answer: Wasim acknowledges his failings as a husband and father, admitting to his selfishness and reliance on Huma while he navigated his fame and addiction. Her discovery of his drug use was a pivotal moment that led him into rehabilitation, signifying the crumbling of their relationship due to his inability to be present.

3.Question

What significant challenges did Wasim face while in rehabilitation, and how did it affect his mental health?

Answer: During rehabilitation, Wasim encountered a substandard facility and a dubious doctor, leading to feelings of frustration and embitterment. He felt isolated from his family and struggled with intense withdrawal and the shame of being in a position of needing help, indicating a struggle against not just physical addiction but also his sense of self-worth.

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4.Question

What pivotal events follows the death of Wasim's wife, Huma, and how do they affect his relationship with his children?

Answer:Huma's death thrust Wasim into extreme mourning, complicating his role as a father. He struggled with the overwhelming responsibilities of parenthood and felt traumatized by his loss. However, this also catalyzed his realization of the need to step up for his children, leading him to relocate to Karachi to honor Huma's wishes and create a stable environment for his sons.

5.Question

Despite Wasim's fame and wealth, what deeper issues do his experiences reveal about the pressures he faced?

Answer:Wasim's journey illustrates how fame can be isolating and demanding, revealing underlying insecurities and emotional turmoil. His struggles with addiction and feelings of inadequacy starkly contrast the public perception

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of a successful athlete, shedding light on the often-hidden complexities of life as a sportsman.

6.Question

What role did Shaniera play in Wasim's life after Huma's passing, and how did their relationship develop?

Answer:Shaniera emerged as a significant and supportive figure in Wasim's life, helping him navigate his grief and restore a sense of normalcy. Initially cautious about starting a new relationship, Wasim found comfort and companionship in her positive spirit, which encouraged him to engage in life again, signifying a turning point in his emotional recovery.

7.Question

How does Wasim view the culture of fame in South Asia, and what impact does it have on his personal life?

Answer:Wasim views the culture of fame as all-consuming and corroding, leading him into reckless behavior that spiraled into addiction. The pressure to maintain a façade of

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celebrity takes a toll on his mental health, indicating the vulnerabilities behind public success.

8.Question

What lessons does Wasim learn about responsibility and family dynamics after Huma's death?

Answer:After Huma's death, Wasim learns the importance of being present for his children and that he cannot rely solely on others for support. He recognizes the gap left by Huma's guidance and how it has made him more accountable for his family's well-being.

9.Question

What does Wasim highlight about the nature of addiction and recovery in his life story?

Answer:Wasim highlights that addiction is not just about substance abuse but also about the emotional voids and pressures faced by athletes post-retirement. His journey through addiction and the struggle to achieve sobriety

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emphasizes the need for support systems and self-awareness in recovery.

10.Question

In what ways did Wasim's perception of himself change throughout the chapter?

Answer: Throughout the chapter, Wasim transitions from viewing himself as an elite athlete defined by cricket success to grappling with the emotional fallout of loss, addiction, and the challenge of rebuilding his identity as a father and individual outside of cricket.

Chapter 15 | 15 A new beginning| Q&A

1.Question

What does Wasim Akram suggest about the importance of education and values in his children's upbringing?

Answer: Wasim emphasizes that education is the greatest gift one can give a child, reflected in the support he provides to his sons in their academic pursuits. He highlights the importance of hard

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work, values, and the ability to take care of oneself, suggesting that these principles are foundational for success in life.

2.Question

How does Wasim Akram reflect on his father's influence in his life and career?

Answer: Wasim describes his father as a hero who lived a life of duty without complaint. He admired his father's even temperament and his ability not to get carried away with success or setbacks. This steadiness became a model for Wasim, shaping his approach to the pressures of being a successful cricketer.

3.Question

What challenges did Wasim and Shaniera face regarding cultural differences when their relationship became public?

Answer: When their relationship became public, Wasim and Shaniera encountered backlash, particularly regarding

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traditional expectations in Pakistan about marriage and relationships. Shaniera had to carefully navigate social media to avoid offending cultural norms, which demonstrated the complexities of their relationship in the face of societal scrutiny.

4.Question

How does Wasim Akram view the changes in cricket and the importance of four-day cricket?

Answer: Wasim asserts that despite the evolution of cricket, four-day cricket remains crucial for developing adaptable cricketers. He believes that mastering four-day play equips players to handle the pressures of shorter formats like T20, arguing for its preservation against the growing trend of T20 dominance.

5.Question

What personal losses did Wasim Akram experience during the 2014 IPL season, and how did they shape his perspective?

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Answer: In 2014, during the IPL, Wasim lost his father, which profoundly affected him. This loss reminded him of the impermanence of life and instilled a deeper appreciation for family and the fleeting nature of success and fame, leading him to reflect on what truly constitutes happiness and fulfillment.

6.Question

What message does Wasim convey about resilience and the ability of Pakistanis to come back after setbacks?

Answer: Wasim conveys a strong message about resilience in the face of adversity, noting that Pakistanis are often criticized for internal divisions yet are capable of coming together again. He reflects on his experiences with teammates and the ability to overcome past animosities for the greater good.

7.Question

How does the narrative of Wasim's life reflect on the larger socio-cultural dynamics within Pakistan?

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Answer: Wasim's narrative illustrates the intersection of personal and national identities within Pakistan. His experiences with cultural expectations, societal pressures, and the challenges of life in Pakistan reflect broader themes of resilience, adaptability, and the complexities of modern

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Pakistani society influenced by global connections.

8.Question

What does Wasim Akram wish for his daughter, Aiyla, in terms of her upbringing compared to his own?

Answer: Wasim hopes for Aiyla to grow up with a broader perspective and more opportunities than he had. He acknowledges that the world she is growing up in is different and more fortunate but also recognizes the challenges that come with it, aiming to support her understanding and navigation of that world.

9.Question

What lessons does Wasim Akram intend to pass on to the next generation, based on his life experiences?

Answer: Wasim intends to pass on principles of hard work, respect, humility, and the importance of education. He believes in the value of maintaining good relationships, dealing with challenges thoughtfully, and appreciating the game of cricket beyond mere statistics or fame.

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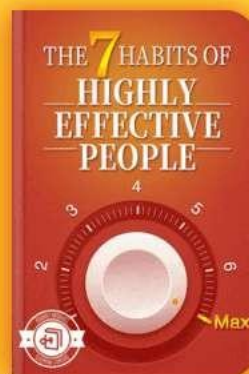
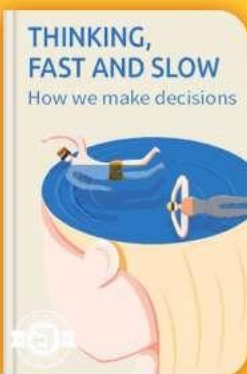


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Sultan Quiz and Test

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Chapter 1 | 1 The boy from the British Government| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram was inspired by watching videos of his idol, Wasim Akram, who later became his bowling coach at Kolkata Knight Riders.
2. Wasim Akram's father worked as a professional cricketer for the British Government.
3. Wasim Akram started to develop an interest in cricket because of the legacy of Imran Khan attending his school.

Chapter 2 | 2 The guru| Quiz and Test

1. In 1985, Wasim Akram's bowling skills were considered on par with Malcolm Marshall's.
2. Imran Khan discouraged Akram from focusing on fitness and hard work during training.
3. Wasim Akram took 5 wickets in his debut match at the Melbourne Cricket Ground with the help of Imran's advice.

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Chapter 3 | 3 Imran, Viv and me| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram's action required significant alteration to harness his talent.
2. Imran Khan's team partook in a diplomatic initiative called 'Cricket for Peace' during a time of unrest between India and Pakistan.
3. Wasim Akram faced no competition from his peers during his early performances in cricket.

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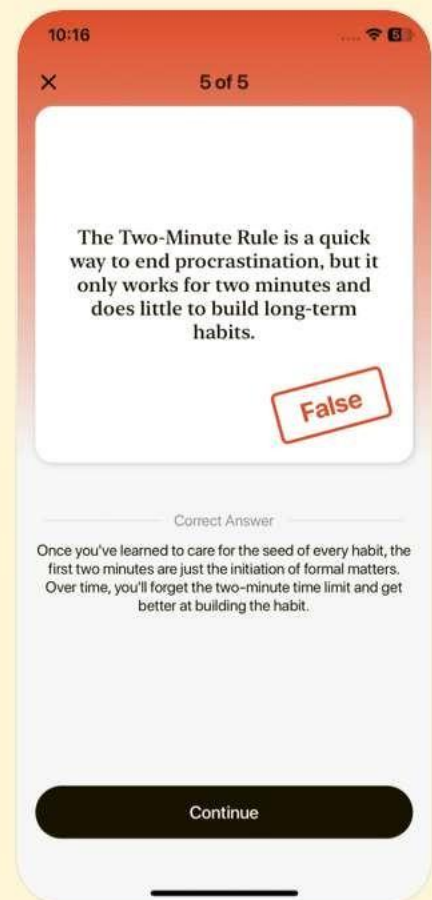


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Chapter 4 | 4 Wasim for England| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram formed a successful bowling partnership with Waqar Younis during his cricket career.
2. Wasim Akram faced no challenges while adapting to the team dynamics in England.
3. Wasim Akram's first-class century was an early achievement that helped him find balance between his heritage and professional career.

Chapter 5 | 5 An all-rounder at last| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram is regarded as one of the greatest left-arm quick bowlers in cricket history.
2. The author believes that bowlers should not focus on becoming competent batters.
3. The author achieved impressive bowling figures during a Test match in Melbourne.

Chapter 6 | 6 1992 and all that| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram is described as both an intimidating cricketer and a gentleman off the field.

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- 2.The Pakistan cricket team lost all of their warm-up matches leading up to the 1992 World Cup.
- 3.Imran Khan had a strong focus on building a cricket hospital in Lahore during the World Cup preparation.

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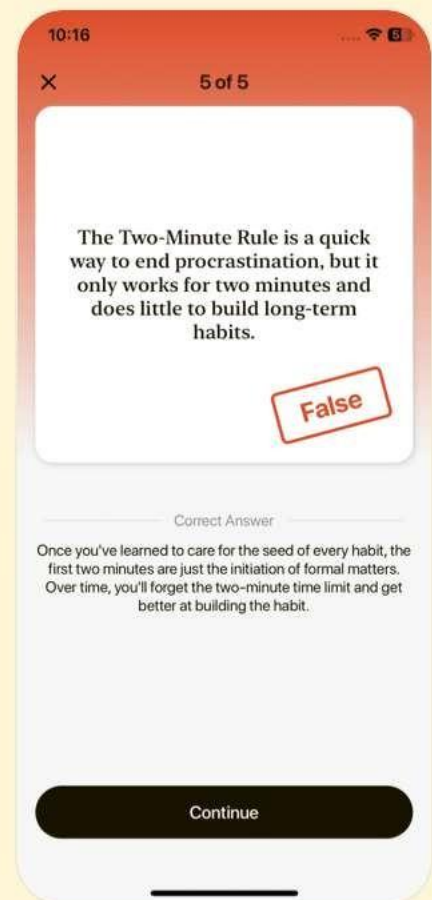


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Chapter 7 | 7 A reluctant captain| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram discusses the close relationship between Javed Miandad and Imran Khan within the Pakistan cricket team.
2. During the summer tour in England, the Pakistan cricket team performed consistently well and was sponsored by Tetley.
3. Akram felt fully equipped and supported for the role of captain after Javed Miandad's leadership faced criticism.

Chapter 8 | 8 Dirty money| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram's unique bowling style earned him recognition among the greatest fast bowlers.
2. Imran Khan encouraged betting on the team's victory to ensure motivation, indicating early signs of corruption in Pakistani cricket.
3. During his career, Akram experienced a strong sense of camaraderie and friendship with his teammates amidst rumors of match-fixing.

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Chapter 9 | 9 Taking on the world| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram returned to captaincy with a positive mindset after previous failures.
2. Wasim Akram's team had a smooth and easy start in the World Cup with no internal struggles.
3. Wasim Akram opened the bowling during the First Test at Hobart and succeeded early on.

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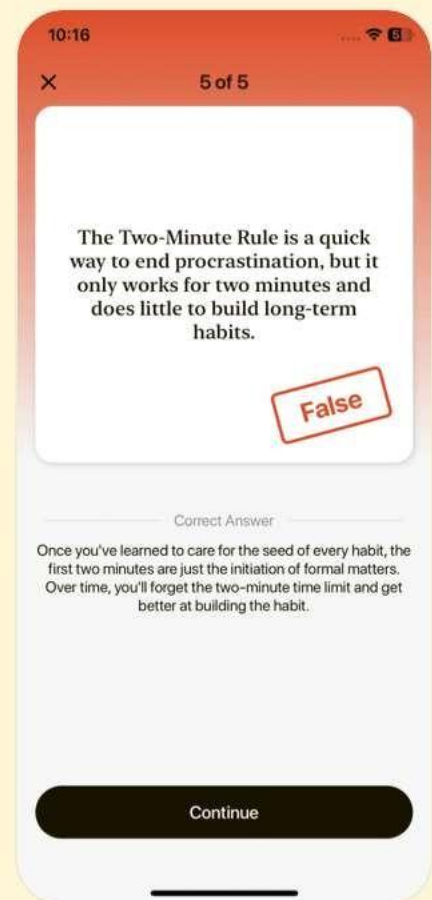


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Chapter 10 | 10 Under investigation| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram faced allegations of match-fixing during his career with the Pakistani cricket team.
2. Akram's career was unaffected by personal challenges, including a diabetes diagnosis.
3. The inquiry into Akram's alleged match-fixing was based on strong evidence and testimonies.

Chapter 11 | 11 Mission to India| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram is recognized for inspiring fast bowlers in the Subcontinent.
2. The 1999 tour to India as captain was met with unanimous support from both Pakistani and Indian fans.
3. Chapter 11 of 'Sultan' discusses the historical rivalry and cricketing relationship between Pakistan and India.

Chapter 12 | 12 A cup forfeited| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram was known as an extraordinary rival for every batter who faced him.
2. The Pakistan cricket team's journey in the 1999 World Cup was free from any allegations of match-fixing.

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3. Pakistan's cricket team had a strong performance in the World Cup, eventually winning the final against Australia.

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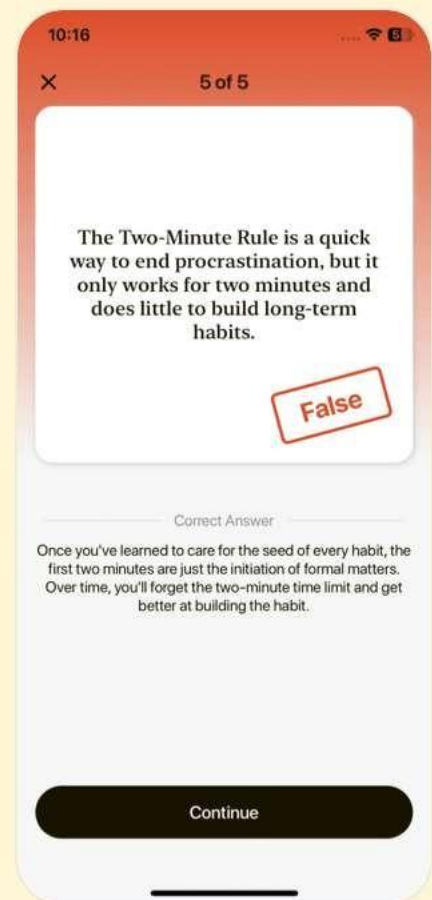


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Chapter 13 | 13 General disarray| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram was recognized as one of cricket's greatest fast bowlers and excelled as an all-rounder.
2. Shoaib Akhtar faced a permanent bowling ban imposed by the ICC, significantly impacting the team's performance.
3. Akram felt his reputation was damaged due to the match-fixing allegations, which he claimed were unfounded.

Chapter 14 | 14 Battling my demons| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram compares his cricketing journey to that of renowned golfer Ben Hogan, showcasing humility and generosity.
2. Wasim Akram's exit from international cricket was celebrated and he received significant accolades during his last appearances.
3. After the passing of his wife Huma, Wasim Akram quickly moved on to another relationship without grappling with his emotions.

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Chapter 15 | 15 A new beginning| Quiz and Test

1. Wasim Akram's insights on swing bowling are revered in cricket communities?
2. Akram's wedding to Shaniera was a grand and extravagant affair.
3. Akram believes T20 cricket is more important than four-day cricket for developing players.

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